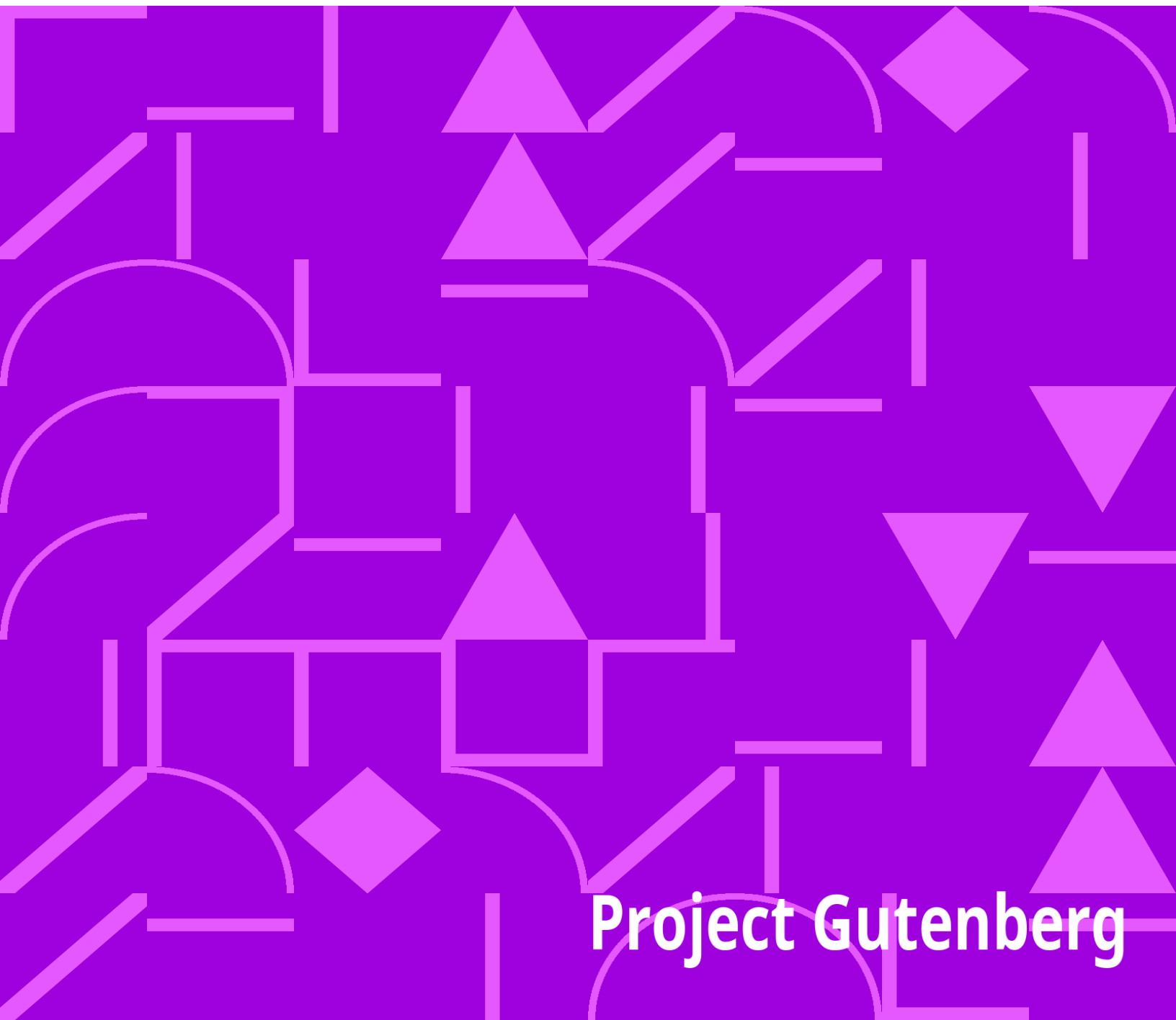


Organizing and Building Up the Sunday School

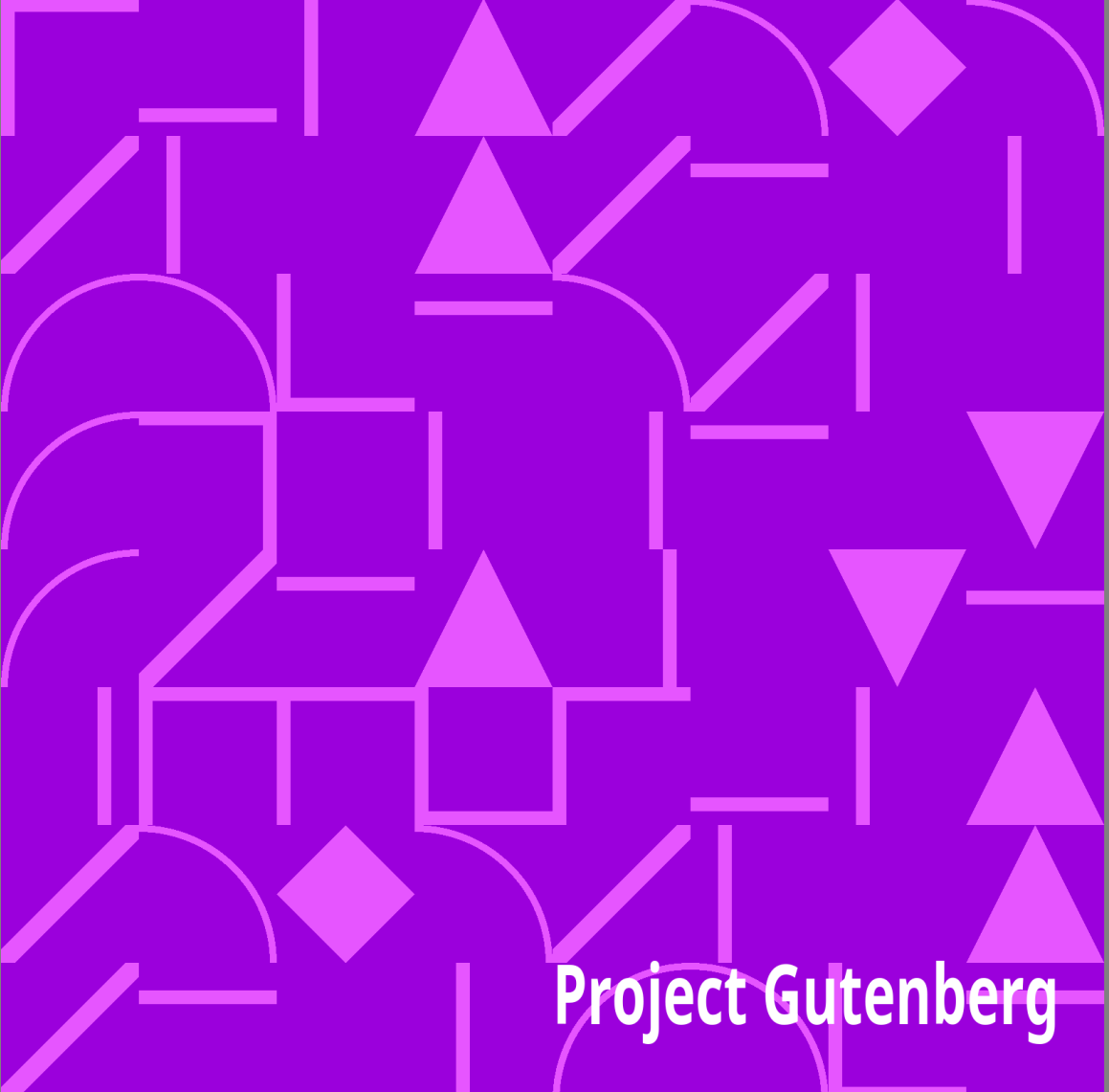
Jesse Lyman Hurlbut

A decorative background pattern consisting of various geometric shapes in shades of purple and magenta. The shapes include triangles (pointing up and down), diamonds, squares, and semi-circles, arranged in a complex, overlapping manner.

Project Gutenberg

Organizing and Building Up the Sunday School

Jesse Lyman Hurlbut



Project Gutenberg

The Project Gutenberg eBook of Organizing and Building Up the Sunday School

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: Organizing and Building Up the Sunday School

Author: Jesse Lyman Hurlbut

Release date: January 24, 2011 [eBook #35050]

Most recently updated: January 7, 2021

Language: English

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/35050

Credits: Produced by Emmy, Charlene Taylor and the Online Distributed Proofreading Team at <https://www.pgdp.net> (This file was produced from images generously made available by The Internet Archive)

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK ORGANIZING
AND BUILDING UP THE SUNDAY SCHOOL ***

MODERN SUNDAY SCHOOL MANUALS
Edited by Charles Foster Kent in

Collaboration with John T. McFarland

ORGANIZING AND BUILDING UP THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

By JESSE LYMAN HURLBUT



NEW YORK: EATON & MAINS
CINCINNATI: JENNINGS & GRAHAM

Copyright, 1910, by
EATON & MAINS

TABLE OF CONTENTS

	PAGE
I. The Historic Principles Underlying the Sunday School Movement	<u>7</u>
II. The Constitution of the Sunday School	<u>14</u>
III. The Necessity and Essentials of a Graded Sunday School	<u>21</u>
IV. The Grading of the Sunday School	<u>30</u>
V. The Departments of the Graded Sunday School	<u>37</u>
VI. The Superintendent	<u>46</u>
VII. The Superintendent's Duties and Responsibilities	<u>53</u>
VIII. The Associate and Department Superintendents	<u>63</u>
IX. The Secretary of the Sunday School	<u>69</u>
X. The Treasury and the Treasurer	<u>75</u>
XI. Value of the Sunday School Library	<u>81</u>
XII. The Management of the Library	<u>91</u>
XIII. The Teacher's Qualifications and Need of Training	<u>98</u>
XIV. The Training and Task of the Teacher	<u>105</u>
XV. The Constituency of the Sunday School	<u>113</u>
XVI. Recruiting the Sunday School	<u>122</u>
XVII. The Tests of a Good Sunday School	<u>129</u>
Appendix	<u>135</u>

PREFATORY

IN the preparation of this volume the purpose was to supply a convenient handbook upon the organization, the management, and the recruiting of the Sunday school, to be read by those desiring information upon these subjects. But after the larger part of the work had been prepared a desire was expressed that the method of treatment be so modified that the volume might be employed as a text-book for classes and individual students in the department of teacher-training. It has been the aim of the author not to alter the work so materially as to render it unfitting for the general reader; and with this in view the series of blackboard outlines for the teacher, and the questions for the testing of the student's knowledge, have been placed at the end of the book. In the hope that both the reader and the student may receive profit from these pages the book is committed to the public.

JESSE LYMAN HURLBUT.

I

THE HISTORIC PRINCIPLES UNDERLYING THE SUNDAY-SCHOOL MOVEMENT

1. **Magnitude of the Sunday-School Movement.** At the opening of the twentieth century the Sunday school stands forth as one of the largest, most widely spread, most characteristic, and most influential institutions of the Anglo-Saxon world. Wherever the English race is found the Sunday school is established, in the Mother isle, on the American continent, at the Cape of Good Hope, and in Australasia. In the United States and Canada it has a following of fourteen million members, representing every religious denomination. Its periodical literature has a wider circulation than that of any other modern educational movement. It touches every class of society, from the highest to the lowest; and its largest membership is found among the young, who are of all ages the most susceptible to formative forces. It is safe to say that this institution has exerted a powerful influence upon the majority of the men and women of to-day, and is now shaping the character of millions who will be the men and women of to-morrow.

2. **A Modern Movement.** Great as it appears in our time, the Sunday school is comparatively a modern institution. Undoubtedly, the germ of it can be traced back to that source of all the religious life of the civilized world, the Hebrew people. The elemental principle of the Sunday school is possibly to be found in the prophetic guilds before the Exile, and the schools of the Jewish scribes after the Restoration. The great Bible class of Ezra (Neh. 8) was not unlike a modern Sunday school. Yet as an organized institution the Sunday school began with Robert Raikes, the philanthropist of Gloucester, England, who on one Sunday in 1780 called together a group of street boys in a room on Sooty Alley, and employed young women to teach them the rudiments of reading and religion. If Raikes had not happened to be the editor of the town newspaper, and in constant need of copy, his Sunday school might soon have been forgotten. But from time to

time he published concerning it paragraphs which were copied into other papers and attracted attention, so that the Sooty Alley Sunday school became the parent of a vast progeny throughout the United Kingdom and beyond the seas. No institution then in existence, or recorded in church history, suggested to Robert Raikes either the name or the plan. Both arose out of his own good heart and active mind. But since his day both the name "Sunday school" and its plan of working have been perpetuated, and every Sunday school in the world is a monument to Robert Raikes, the editor of Gloucester.

3. A Lay Movement. It is a significant fact that the first Sunday school was established not by a priest, but by a private member of the Church of England, that its earliest teachers were not curates, nor sisters, but young women of the laity, and that throughout its history the movement has been directed and carried forward, in all lands and among nearly all denominations, by lay workers.^[1] This is noteworthy, because in the eighteenth century, far more than in our time, the teaching of religion was regarded as the peculiar function of the clergy, and lay preaching was frowned upon as irregular. The earliest Sunday school may have been preserved from churchly opposition by its own insignificance; or it may have won the favor of the clergy by the fact that all its pupils at the close of the morning session were regularly marched to church. Whatever the cause may have been, it is certain that under a providence which we must regard as divine, both in its beginning and throughout its history, the Sunday school, although a laymen's movement, has received favor, and not opposition, from the clergy and the Church.

4. Unpaid Workers. It has been stated that Raikes paid the young women who taught in his Sunday school a penny for each Sunday. But as the movement went onward the conductors and teachers were soon giving their service freely; and this has been the prevailing rule throughout the world. There are a few Sunday schools wherein a curate or assistant pastor is the superintendent, and a few mission schools that employ a salaried teacher who works through the week as a visitor; but it may be asserted that the world-wide army of Sunday-school workers lay upon the altar of the Church their free-hearted, unpaid offering of time, study, and effort. This has been and is a noble, a self-denying, a splendid service; but it has also been a potent element in the progress of the movement. Those who would

establish a school, alike in the city and on the frontier, have not been compelled to wait until funds could be raised for the salary of a superintendent and teachers. If only churches rich enough to pay for workers had established Sunday schools in our country, the Sunday school as an institution would not have advanced westward with the wave of population. And not only has the unpaid service aided the growth of the movement, it has also added to its moral and religious power. The pupils and their parents have recognized that the teachers were working not for pay, but from love for their scholars and their Saviour; and that love has imparted to their message a power all its own.

5. Self-supporting. The Sunday school has been from the beginning and even now remains in large measure a self-supporting movement. It everywhere involves expense for furniture, for teaching requisites, for song books, for libraries; but for the most part the money to meet these expenses has been contributed in the school, among its own members, and not by the church. Instances are on record, even, where the church, in former times, charged and received rent for the use of its property by the Sunday school! Such short-sighted practice has been rare, but multitudes of churches have found the Sunday school a source of far greater profit than expense. In other words, those who have done the work of the school have also paid its bills, and many families that have received its benefits have been exempt from its burdens. It is noteworthy, however, that this condition is passing away, that churches are awakening to their responsibility and opportunity, and are giving to the Sunday school that liberal support which its work requires and deserves. In the ratio of investment and return, no department of the church costs so little and rewards so richly as an efficient Sunday school.

6. Self-governing. As a result of being self-supporting, the Sunday school has also been a self-governing institution. Paying its own way and asking no favor, it has been almost everywhere an independent body, accepting no outside authority. It has grown up almost unrecognized and unnoticed by the churches. Fifty years ago scarcely one of the denominations, great or small, gave the Sunday school recognition as an integral part of its system. Little attention was paid to it in the ruling body of the local church. It chose its own officers, obtained its own teachers, made its own rules, and for its teachings was responsible to no ecclesiastical authority. It was generally an ally to, but independent of, the church. In this

respect a gradual change has taken place. Its relations are now much closer, its position is defined; and the institution is sanctioned and supervised by the church.

7. Self-developing. The system of the Sunday school has been evolved without guidance or control from any human authority. It has been from the first self-organizing, and has been also self-developing. Some might consider the form which it has taken accidental; but it is better to regard it as providential. The men and women who laid the foundations of the Sunday school were building under a divine direction of which they were unconscious. Working apart from each other, on both sides of the sea, and separated by wilderness and prairie, everywhere they established an institution under the same general principles, and with substantial unity in its plans. Perhaps one cause for its unity of method is that it arose in the midst of the Anglo-Saxon race, a people which has instinctive tendencies toward law, system, and organization. If it had started among a Latin people, where men, and not systems, rule, there might have been a different form of organization, with different aims, with different titles for officers, in every province. But throughout the English-speaking world, which is the habitat of the Sunday school, the institution bears the same name. Its principal or conductor is called a superintendent—cumbersome though the title may be—and its working force are known as teachers.

8. Bible Study. The most prominent trait in the Sunday school of the present is that it has become the most extensive movement for instruction in the Sacred Scriptures that the world has yet seen. All these millions of members, young and old, are engaged in the study of one book—the Holy Bible. Many of these millions, indeed, study the Bible superficially, unintelligently, with narrow interpretations and crude methods; yet in the Sunday schools of the lowest type as well as of the highest some portion of the Bible every week is brought to the scholars' attention. That the Bible is so generally known and so widely circulated, that the demand for this ancient book warrants the printing of more than ten million copies every year, is due more to the Sunday school, with all its defects of method, than to any other institution. This concentration of attention upon the Bible has grown gradually in the Sunday school. In the eighteenth century Sunday school, both of England and America, religious instruction was only one of its aims; and it was instruction in the catechism and forms of worship rather

than in the Bible. But by slow degrees the Bible came more prominently to the front, until now the Sunday school is everywhere the school with one text-book. He who surveys the Sunday school through the inner eye beholds it on one day in each week covering the continent with its millions of students, all face to face with some portion of the great text-book of religion. The thoughtful observer will reflect that a people whose children and youth come into weekly contact with the living word will not wander far from the path of righteousness.

II

THE CONSTITUTION OF THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

The general characteristics of the Sunday school, as they have gradually developed during its long history, must be considered in any plan for organizing and conducting an individual school. The institution should be studied both ideally and practically: practically, to ascertain what the Sunday school has been and is now; yet ideally, with a view to developing its highest efficiency and largest usefulness. Such a plan for the specific Sunday school may be called its constitution. It is desirable to have the constitution in written or printed form, but it is not necessary. There is no more complete system than the government of Great Britain, yet it has no written constitution; and Mr. James Bryce has shown us in America that the instrument known as the Constitution of the United States by no means represents our own actual method of government. In every nation there is an unwritten law, wrought out of a people's consciousness, which is more imperative and enduring than any parchment scroll or printed form.

The general principles to be maintained in establishing and developing a Sunday school are the following:

1. **Aim.** The primary aims of the Sunday school are religious instruction, character-development, and effective service. It is not to teach history, nor science, nor sociology, but religion; and not merely to impart a knowledge of religion to the intellect of its pupils, but, infinitely more important, to make religion an effective force in the life of the individual scholar. As a Christian institution, in the definition given by one of its greatest leaders,[\[2\]](#) "The Sunday school is a department of the Church of Christ, in which the word of Christ is taught, for the purpose of bringing souls to Christ, and of building up souls in Christ." If it be in connection with a Jewish synagogue or temple—as are some of the best Sunday schools or Sabbath schools in our land—it is for the purpose of instruction in the faith of the ancient fathers, and of making their teachings live again in the men and women of

to-day. A true religious education, such as the Sunday school seeks to give, will include three aims: (1) knowledge, (2) character, (3) service. There must be an intellectual grasping of the truth; a character built on the truth, out of faith in God, and the life of God inspiring the human soul; and service for God and humanity. The Sunday school seeks to develop not only saints in fellowship with God, but workers for God, who shall strive to realize on earth the kingdom of God, not seeking to be ministered unto but to minister. There have been centuries in the past when the Christian ideal was the cloistered saint, living apart in communion with God. But that was a pitifully incomplete conception of the perfect man. In our age we have the larger ideal of saintliness with service; and to promote this should be the aim of every Sunday school.

2. **Method.** To attain its aim the Sunday school employs the teaching method. The Sunday school is not, as some weak-minded people have called it, "the nursery of the church." Nor is it, as it has been named, "the Bible service"; for, although it holds a service, it is more than a service. It is not—or should not be—a gathering of groups, large or small, where silent hearers listen to sermonettes by little preachers, miscalled teachers. It holds a service imbued with the spirit of worship, yet worship is not its central purpose. It should have music, but it is not primarily a service of song. It should be pervaded by an atmosphere of happiness, but mere enjoyment is not its object. The Sunday school is a *school*: and the very word shows that its aim is instruction and character formation, and its method is that of teaching. For the work of a Sunday school the essentials are three:

(1) There must be the living teacher who is fitted to inspire, to instruct, and to guide. His part is not merely to pour knowledge into his pupils, but to awaken thought, to guide the search for truth, to call forth expression in character and in action.[\[3\]](#)

(2) There must also be the scholar who is to be taught. It is his part in the process of instruction not merely to listen and to remember, not merely to receive impressions, but to give expression to the teaching, in life, in character, in influence, and in service. The true effectiveness of the teaching in the Sunday school will be shown by the reproductive power of the truth in the life of the scholar.

(3) There must be a text-book in the hands of both the teacher and the pupil. In any school for religious instruction one book will of necessity stand prominent, that great Book of books which records the divine revelation to man. The Sunday school may teach history, geography, institutions, doctrines, literature of the Bible, but these only as a framework or a foundation for the education of the heart into a personal fellowship with God. This character-molding, faith-impelling force is the divine truth taught in the Bible through the experiences and teachings of patriarchs, prophets, priests, psalmists, sages, and apostles, and above all by the words and life and redemptive work of the Master himself. And the subjects of study in the Sunday school need not be limited to the text of Scripture. There may be extra-biblical material for the teaching of character and service; and all this should be open to the Sunday school.

3. Relation to the Church. However independent of the church organization the Sunday school may have been in its beginnings, and however self-dependent some union Sunday schools may of necessity be in certain churchless regions, the general fact is established that the Sunday school as an institution belongs to the church, is under the care of the church, has a claim upon moral and financial support by the church, should be a feeder to the membership of the church, and should gratefully accept the supervision of the church. It should regard itself and be recognized by all as in many ways the most important department of the church.

4. Government. All power must be under direction, and the mighty energies of the Sunday school especially need a wise, strong guidance. In the general management of the Sunday school two elements should be recognized: (1) the rights of the workers and (2) the authority of the church.

(1) It must ever be kept in mind that the Sunday school is an army of volunteers. Its workers are men and women who of their own accord give to the school without compensation their gift of service. Those who make such a contribution to the success of the Sunday school should certainly have a voice in its management.

(2) But it is not to be forgotten, on the other side, that the Sunday school is not superior to the church, nor independent of it, but subsidiary to it; hence the church should be able to exercise some control over the school if

such control shall ever be needed. For example, in the choice of a superintendent, who is the executive officer of the school, the ruling body of the local church and the working body of teachers and officers should unite. No one should undertake to conduct a church Sunday school unless he thus has the definite assurance that his teachers are with him, and that his church is officially supporting him.

5. Officers. Little need be said here on this subject, for it is one with which every worker is familiar.

(1) There must be a leader, or manager, the executive head of the school, who is universally styled the superintendent. If we were organizing a new institution, and not describing one already world-wide and with officers already named by common usage and consent, we would prefer that the executive of the Sunday school receive the title of Principal or Director; but the somewhat awkward word Superintendent is settled upon him, and will remain.

(2) There must also be an assistant superintendent, or more than one, as the size of the school may demand. The better title is associate superintendent, as is now given in the larger number of well-organized schools. The superintendent should have the privilege of nominating his own associates or assistants, the nominations to be confirmed by the board of teachers and officers.

(3) There will be a secretary, with such assistants as he may require, to be nominated by the secretary and confirmed by the teachers.

(4) There will be a treasurer, to care for the funds, and to disburse them as ordered by the board of teachers, or the Sunday school as a whole.

(5) Lastly, but most important of all, there must be the working force of instructors, the faculty of the institution, its teachers, who should be carefully chosen. The pastor, as well as the superintendent, should have an active voice in their call, since they are his coworkers in the religious instruction of the congregation.

6. Membership. In the conception of a Sunday school, both ideal and practical, the constituency for which it is established must be considered. As has been noted, it was originally for children only, and only for children

who were destitute of home training, and outside of church relationship. The earliest Sunday schools were what are called in England ragged schools, and in America mission schools. But in the noble evolution of the movement the Sunday school constituency has been vastly enlarged; and now it is recognized that the Sunday school is for all ages and all classes. It should embrace the young and old, the ignorant and intelligent, the poor and rich, the sinner as well as the saint. The Sunday school which fulfills its mission to society will welcome all the world.

III

THE NECESSITY AND ESSENTIALS OF A GRADED SUNDAY SCHOOL

1. **The Necessity of Grading.** As the result of the gradual and unguided evolution of the Sunday school through a century or longer, most schools are now divided in a vague way into certain departments, generally known as the Primary, or Infant Class; the Youths Department, or Boys and Girls; and the Adult Department, or Bible Classes. Many who have charge of schools such as these regard them as graded, and so report them. But the mere naming of departments does not constitute a graded school. Whoever studies the ungraded or loosely graded Sunday school will perceive in it certain evils which can be removed only by a thorough system of grading, maintained faithfully through a series of years. Some of these conditions which make the graded Sunday school an absolute necessity are the following:

(1) *The School as a Whole.* The close observer, looking at the entire school, notes first of all that its gains and its losses in membership are at the extremes of its constituency. It is the normal condition for the gains to come in the Primary section; for the little children in families are attracted to the school or brought there by older children. There is almost invariably a constant increase in this department, requiring frequently the organization of new classes in the grade above, among the younger boys and girls. But, on the other hand, there is a constant loss of older scholars. In most schools, at the age of fourteen, in what is known as the early adolescent period of life, the pupils, for one reason or another, begin to drop out, and few enter to take their places. Almost every school is thus growing at the bottom and dying at the top. The Primary classes are full, but the classes of those above fourteen years are usually small—two large boys here, three yonder. And although girls continue in the school more frequently than boys, there will appear the same conditions—some large classes of girls and young women,

but others where discouraged teachers are sitting down with one, two, or three pupils. Six or eight years ago these same classes came out from the Primary Department, each with eight or ten pupils; now they are mere skeleton classes, barely alive, and threatened with dissolution. Every earnest, thoughtful superintendent would rejoice to find some plan that will guarantee large classes of young people between sixteen and eighteen years of age, for this is the most vital period in the life of the individual. Such a plan is proposed in the graded system.

(2) *The Condition of the Classes.* Fixing the attention upon the several classes, the critic of the school system notes three unfavorable conditions:

(a) There is the inequality in the size of classes, to which reference has already been made. When classes come together by accident, pupils bringing their friends, or new members joining whatever classes they please, some classes of boys or girls will inevitably be too large for good government or good teaching, and others will be too small to create any enthusiasm, either in the teacher or the pupils.

(b) There is also an inequality in the ages of pupils in the same class. A class may include one pupil or two pupils sixteen years old, and others as young as ten, or even nine years; some who during the week are in the high school, and others who can scarcely read the verses assigned to them.

(c) Where these inequalities of numbers and ages exist there is a lack of that class spirit which is an essential element of power in a well-ordered Sunday school. Every class should be a unit, with a strong social bond; but this ideal cannot be realized when there are in the class two or three youths in the noisy, assertive, self-conscious stage of early adolescence, and others who are several years younger. Nor can there be a proper social bond in a class with only two or three members. They are likely to be irregular in attendance, to find excuses for absence or for leaving the school, until at last the discouraged teacher and the listless scholars together drop out of sight.

For the correction of these evils of inequality in numbers and in ages, and of this lack of class spirit, the only successful method is to grade the school, and resolutely to keep it graded.

(3) *Difficulties of Administration.* The difficulties which confront the superintendent in the management of an ungraded school are many and great.

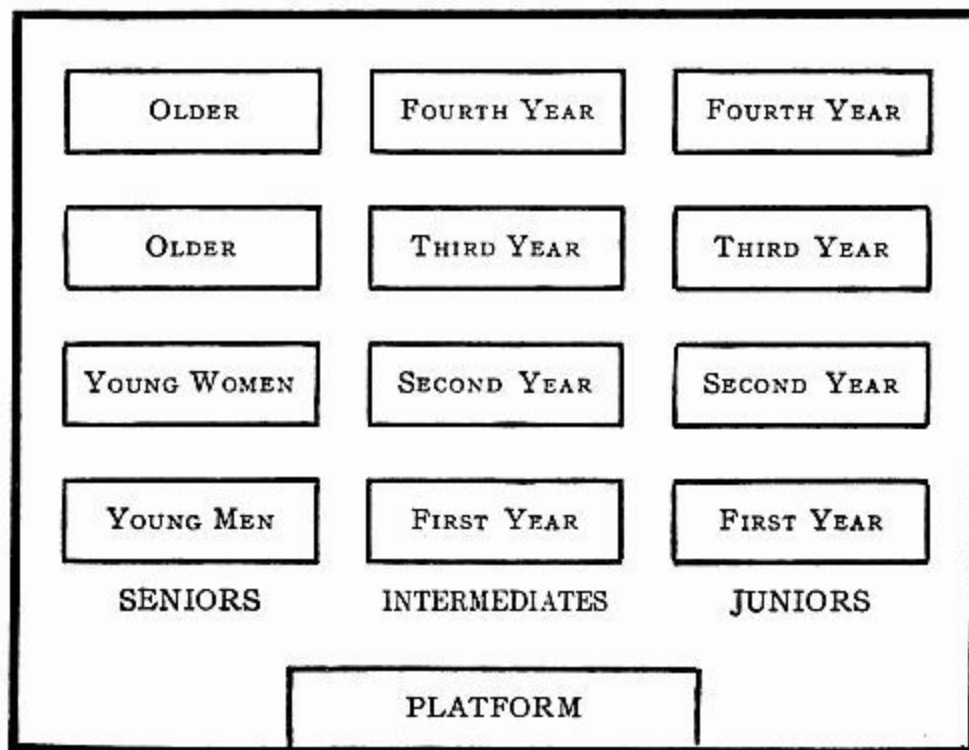
(a) The first and ever-present difficulty is in obtaining teachers for new classes. The constant growth of the Primary Department is his perennial perplexity. To relieve the congestion in the crowded Infant Class its older pupils must be brought into the main school, and teachers must be found for them. The superintendent is always seeking, and often seeking vainly, for new teachers.

(b) Another difficulty is found in the attempt to transfer scholars from one class to another. No matter how much out of place a pupil may be, it is almost impossible to transfer him to another class without incurring the displeasure of the teacher, the scholar, or the scholar's family. And however overgrown or ill-assorted a class may have become, to divide it is a delicate task, almost sure to cause ill feeling. Also, when there arises the need of a teacher for a new class just emerging from the Primary Department, the natural plan would be to combine some of the skeleton classes in the other departments, and thereby release a teacher for service with the new class. But the superintendent who attempts this plan finds that almost invariably it results in some of the older scholars leaving the school because their teacher is taken from them.

2. The Essentials of a Graded School. Briefly stated, the essentials of a graded Sunday school are the following:[\[4\]](#)

(1) *Departments.* The graded Sunday school is organized in certain distinct groups, of which the most important, for our present purpose, are the Primary, Junior, Intermediate, and Senior Departments. To these will be added the Beginners and Adult Departments when the subject comes up for a complete treatment. Each of these departments should have, if possible, a separate room; but if these rooms cannot be provided in the building, the pupils should be seated by departments in the different parts of the one room. Perhaps it may be assumed that there is a separate room for the Primary Department; then let those who have most recently come from the Primary be seated on the right block of seats; the Youths or Intermediate in the middle; and the Senior classes on the left block, or vice versa. The

younger classes of the department should have the front seats, the older those in the rear, in regular gradation. The school may be arranged in the order shown in this diagram:



(2) *Classes.* The number of classes should be fixed for each department, and their relationship established, so that when a group of scholars is promoted to a higher grade in the same department, or in the next department, they do not enter as classes, but as individuals; not to form new classes in the department, but to be placed in classes already formed. This plan will keep the classes in the Senior Department always full, and avoid the unfortunate skeleton classes of the ungraded school. It will also impress upon the pupils the importance of faithful work.

(3) *Promotions.* There should be annual and simultaneous promotions throughout the school. One Sunday in the year should be set apart as Promotion Sunday; and on that day all promotions should be made. Those who are to be advanced from the Intermediate to the Senior Department are called out by name and placed in their classes, which are not new classes, but old classes replenished with new members. These promotions will vacate the seats of the Fourth Year classes in the Intermediate Department.

But these seats will at once be filled by the Third Year now becoming the Fourth Year, and taking their seats; the Second Year pupils becoming the Third Year; and the First Year the Second Year. The First Year of the Intermediate Department will be left vacant, to be filled by promotion of the Fourth Year in the Junior Department, and the moving up of classes to the year above in the same department; and the First Year of the Junior Department will be filled by promotion from the Primary Department.

(4) *Teachers.* As groups of scholars pass either from one grade or from one department to another there must also be a change of teachers. This constitutes the crux of the entire system, and in its inception is apt to prove the most formidable obstacle in grading the school. The pupils, however, are accustomed to a system of promotions in the day school, and expect to leave their teachers when they change their grades; but many of the teachers in the Sunday school, not being trained under the system, dislike to lose their scholars, and show their dissatisfaction in ways that affect their pupils. This difficulty must be overcome by tact and an appeal to unselfish motives; teachers must consent for the sake of the common good to give up their old classes and take new ones which begin in the department. The teacher may remain in the grade and receive a new class each year as his pupils advance to a higher grade; or he may remain with the class and advance until the pupils pass from their former department to a higher one, as from Primary to Junior, from Junior to Intermediate, and from Intermediate to Senior. He should then return to a new first year's class in his own department and lead it through the course. If any teacher asks, "Why cannot I go with my class into the Senior Department?" the answer is that if the plan be permitted for one it must be recognized for all; and in the Senior Department there will follow an increasing number of classes, with a relatively diminishing membership in each class. The scholars also need the inspiration of contact with different teachers. Furthermore, the teacher who is adapted to the Junior or Intermediate Department is rarely a suitable teacher for Senior scholars. Hence there is need of a careful assignment of teachers no less than of pupils. Therefore, to maintain a graded school the pupils must change teachers when they change departments.

(5) *Lessons.* There should be graded lessons for each department. If a graded system be followed in the school, as it should be, with different subjects, text-books, and lessons for each department, giving to the entire

school a regular, systematic, progressive curriculum, this requisite will be met. If, however, the uniform lesson for all the school be followed, as at present is still the case in many Sunday schools, the graded teaching must be given in the form of supplemental lessons, taught by the head of the department where it has a separate room, or by the teacher if the departments must be assembled in one room. In some form the graded teaching is an absolutely essential requisite of the graded school. Most schools, when once thoroughly graded, will realize the need of the next step in the evolution of the institution—lessons graded in subjects as well as in methods for the several departments.

(6) *Basis of Promotion.* The question is often asked, "Should promotions be made on the basis of age, or as the result of examinations?" The examination system may be regarded as desirable in the Sunday school, but there are as yet few schools where thorough examinations can be rigidly insisted on as a part of the school system, and promotions invariably made to depend upon standing. A school which meets only once a week, for a session of less than an hour and a half, and with but one lesson period of forty minutes or even less, cannot maintain the same strictness in its standards as the public school. Moreover, new scholars are continually entering the schools, and, while most of them begin at the foot of the ladder in the Primary Department, yet others enter at various ages and in various grades. Any system of promotion based merely upon acquirement attested by examination is sure to become in many instances a meaningless form when applied to the Sunday school. Yet acquirements and examinations need not be ignored in the graded Sunday school. There may be certain ages at which the pupils shall by right pass from a lower grade to a higher. But it may also be arranged that pupils who are exceptionally bright, well-informed, and studious can be promoted a year in advance of their classmates by passing examination. Let the examination be given in writing to all the pupils, and let all be urged to take it; with the promise that those who pass will be promoted, even though they be less than the required age. But let it also be understood that failure to pass the examination will not keep the student for more than one year from promotion. In other words, the examination may well be made the door through which earnest students may pass on, and so keep abreast of their equals in training and ability.

IV

THE GRADING OF THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

The question is often asked, "How may an ungraded Sunday school be placed on a graded basis?" The work may seem simple, and easy of accomplishment, but when it is undertaken difficulties arise which must be intelligently and tactfully met.

1. **The Difficulties.** If all our Sunday-school teachers were trained educators, accustomed to the methods of the public school, they would see at once the advantages of the graded system, and heartily enter into it. But most of our teachers are untrained, and their range of vision often fails to reach beyond their own class and their immediate environment. The relation between teachers and scholars is personal rather than official; and on both sides the personal equation often complicates the problem. In every school there are a few teachers who are so strongly influenced by their feeling for their pupils that they fail to recognize the needs of the school. There are also scholars, especially in the sentimental early adolescent age, who are unwilling to leave their teachers when promotion is offered to them. But unless the change of teachers is maintained the graded system will utterly fail to benefit the school; it will be graded in name only, and not in fact. This part of the program must be carried through, even though it may cost the school the loss of a teacher or two teachers and their scholars.

2. **The Remedy** for this difficulty is only to be found in carefully considered action by presenting the necessity and value of the plan so clearly that the teachers as a whole will fully understand it, appreciate its importance, and heartily accept it. The grading should not be attempted upon the mere fiat of the superintendent, nor on the vote of a bare majority of the workers. The teachers must recognize the self-sacrifice which it requires, and must make that self-sacrifice generously, giving up their scholars for the general good. The possible objections of the scholars are more easily overcome, for they are accustomed in the public schools to

promotions with change of teachers, and readily accommodate themselves to the same system in the Sunday school. Thoughtfulness and kindness, with time, will soon remove the hindrances from the path of the graded school.

3. The Method of Grading. The school may be graded in either of two ways, the gradual or the simultaneous method.

(1) In the gradual method the superintendent, with the concurrence of the teachers, may announce that after a certain date all promotions will be made in accordance with the graded system, leaving the classes as they are until the time for promotion arrives. Then promote from Primary to Junior, from Junior to Intermediate, and from Intermediate to Senior, according to the principles of the graded school; and in four or five years, if the system be maintained, the result will be a school fully graded in all its departments.

(2) In the simultaneous method of grading, the plan must be carefully matured, and general coöperation of all assured. The following plan has been tested in more than one school, and found to work successfully:

(a) Let a careful committee be chosen to arrange the details of grading. The committee should consist of teachers acquainted with the scholars as far as may be practicable, and should, of course, include the superintendent. They should also take an abundance of time for their work.

(b) Obtain the ages of all the scholars between eight and eighteen years of age, and, approximatively, the ages up to thirty. Let this list be made quietly by each teacher for his or her own class. It may be desirable not to inform the pupils for what purpose the enrollment is made. Instances have been known where scholars have understated their ages, hoping thereby to remain with favorite teachers.

(c) Let the committee go over the lists and assign the scholars to classes according to age and acquirement. In some degree social relations should be considered, so that each class may be as far as practicable a social unit. In the Intermediate Department boys and girls should be in separate classes, and not more than six or eight pupils should be placed in one class. No announcement of the assignment of scholars to classes should be made until the day fixed for the reorganization of the school. It will be a good plan to

prepare a map or chart of the schoolroom, with the place proposed for each class indicated upon it.

(d) On the day appointed, after the opening exercises, first let the seats or rooms set apart for the Senior Department be vacated; and then let the roll be called according to the new list. "Class No. 1, Senior Department. Mr. A——, with the following scholars." As their names are called let them take their places, until the list of classes and scholars in this department is filled. Next vacate the seats assigned to the Intermediate Department, and let these teachers and pupils take their places; then the Junior Department, according to the same plan. The Primary Department can be graded by its superintendent or teacher without aid from the committee.

Let it be understood that every scholar must take the place assigned to him at the time when his name is called; and that only for an important reason can an assignment, when once made, be changed. In a large school there will be found a few cases where the committee has made a mistake, even with the greatest care; and these mistakes should be rectified, but not until the pupils have taken their new places temporarily in the scheme of the school.

4. Advantages of Thorough Grading. Many benefits will follow from the proper organization of the school; and their value will be increasingly apparent as the system is maintained through a series of years.

(1) *Appearance.* It is the testimony of every superintendent and pastor who has graded his Sunday school that the appearance of the school is greatly improved by the graded system. The older scholars are assembled in one body, instead of being scattered throughout the room; scholars of the same size and age are brought together in classes. The school will also actually seem larger than it was before the grading.

(2) *Order.* The order of the school will be more easily maintained. The big boys and the giggling girls, both at the self-conscious, awkward age, will be in a new environment, no longer the leaders over smaller and younger pupils, but in classes by themselves, and with responsibilities appealing to their self-respect.

(3) *Social Relations*. It will be a benefit to the scholars of each age to be associated in groups of the same period in life, with the same interests and similar mental acquirements. Many scholars will find their new associations more congenial than their former ones in the ungraded classes, where older and younger people have been brought together. The class will now become, far more than it was before, a social power.

(4) *Teaching Work*. In the ungraded class, with older and younger pupils together, the teacher met with his greatest difficulty in finding a common ground of interest. In the graded class, with pupils of uniform age and equal intellectual understanding, the teaching can be better adapted to the needs of the pupils.

(5) *Incentive to Interest*. The prospect of promotion awakens an interest in the classes. Each scholar looks forward to the time when he will attain to a higher grade with its enlarged privileges.

(6) *Obtaining Teachers*. The grading of the school greatly aids in the solution of the ever-present problem of obtaining new teachers, (a) The graded school requires a smaller number of teachers than the ungraded school, since it provides for the consolidation of skeleton classes in the Senior Department. This sets at liberty a number of experienced teachers for service in other grades. (b) Whenever a new class comes from the Primary Department, a teacher is already at hand in the Junior Department whose class at the same time has advanced to the Intermediate Department. The teacher goes year by year with his class until it leaves the department, and then he returns to a new class beginning the studies of the same department. (c) After the results of a teacher-training class are available there will always be trained teachers waiting for classes.

(7) *Leakage Period*. The young people between fifteen and twenty years of age constitute the "leakage period,"^[5] when they are in great danger of drifting away from the school. They will be held to the school far more firmly if they have before them the prospect of membership in large classes of young people, with social opportunities, and club life, so popular with youth at the early adolescent age. It has been clearly shown by practical experience that an organized Senior Department, with large classes kept full by regular reinforcement from the Intermediate Department, will maintain

itself and hold its members, while skeleton classes of the young people constantly tend to disintegration.

The well-organized, completely graded Sunday school possesses such evident and great advantages that it is certain to be established wherever thorough and efficient religious instruction is sought. The sooner it comes, and the more faithfully it is maintained, the better it will be for the church of to-day and to-morrow, and the more quickly and effectually will the grave problems of our modern civilization be solved.

V

THE DEPARTMENTS OF THE GRADED SUNDAY SCHOOL

General Scheme. The four departments essential to a graded Sunday school, whether large or small, have already been named by anticipation. But it is necessary to give to the subject a closer consideration, and to add the names of other departments which are needed either as departments or subdivisions in the school. Following the analogy of the secular schools, the great divisions of a Sunday school may be named as Elementary, Secondary, and Advanced or Adult. The Elementary Division will include the Cradle Roll, Beginners, Primary, and Junior, taking the scholar up to twelve years of age. The Secondary Division will include the Intermediate and Senior Departments, also the Teacher-training Class, and will embrace the scholars between twelve and twenty years of age. The Advanced or Adult Division will include all the classes wherein the average age is above twenty years, including the Home Department. Beginning with the youngest children, the departments of a thoroughly organized school are the following:

1. **The Cradle Roll.**^[6] This should include all the little ones in the families of the congregation who are too young to attend the school. Their names, in large lettering, in plain print rather than script, should be recorded upon a list, framed and hung upon the wall in the Primary room. A separate card catalogue should be kept of the names alphabetically arranged, with ages, birthdays, parents' names, and the street address of each family. Every effort should be made to keep the list complete; children should inform their teachers of new little brothers and sisters for the Cradle Roll; the pastor in his visitation should take their names and report them; and the teacher or conductor in charge of the Cradle Roll should occasionally visit every family on the list. Whenever gifts are made to the pupils of the school, as at Christmas or on birthdays, toys and dolls for the little ones of the Cradle

Roll should not be forgotten. In a small school the care of the roll and the visiting of the families may be assigned to the Primary superintendent; but in a large Sunday school it will call for a special conductor, and recognition as a separate department. Let no one suppose that this is an unimportant, sentimental matter. The Cradle Roll, maintained as it should be, will awaken interest in every family having a name inscribed upon it, and in due time will lead many little feet to the Sunday school.

2. The Beginners Department. At about three years of age the little children should be brought to the school, and be regularly enrolled as attending members, their names being now taken from the Cradle Roll. They should remain in the Beginners Department from the age of three to that of six years—the Kindergarten period in the public school. Here they should be told simple Bible and nature stories, without effort to place the stories in chronological order; for children of this age have only a faint conception of the sequence of events. They may be taught simple songs, marching exercises, etc. It is a mistake, however, to give them much, if any lessons, to tax the memory, beyond a few short sentences of the Bible and verses of children's songs. If they can meet in a room by themselves, with their own teacher, it will be better than to have them in the Primary room; for the work in this grade should be constantly varied, and the stories very brief, in order not to weary the little ones. If they must meet in the room with the Primary children, they should sit by themselves as a separate section, and not with their older brothers and sisters.

3. The Primary Department. This department should be the home of little children between six and eight or nine years of age. They should remain in it until in the day school they have begun to read. Boys and girls may be placed in the same classes, which should be for those six years old, seven years old, and eight years old, respectively. With each year their seats should be changed, indicating their promotion from the lower to the higher classes. In this department the simpler stories of the Bible and other helpful stories adapted to the grade should not only be told but taught, and the children expected not only to learn but also to tell them. The Twenty-third Psalm, the Lord's Prayer, the Ten Commandments, a few other selected passages of Scripture, and some standard hymns of the Church should be memorized.

In many well-organized Sunday schools both the Cradle Roll and the Beginners class are recognized as subdivisions of the Primary Department, and are under the direction of the Primary superintendent.

4. The Junior Department. This department will care for the children from the ages of eight or nine until the full age of twelve; except that boys or girls who are especially advanced in intelligence may be promoted upon examination at eleven years. In a very small Sunday school all the pupils of this department may form one class, provided they can have a room by themselves. If they must meet with the rest of the school, they may be organized either in two classes, one of boys, the other of girls. If, however, the number of scholars will admit, it is far better to place the pupils in separate classes for boys and girls, with different classes for each year of the period. To scholars of the Junior grade the great characters and events of Bible history should be taught in their order; also the most important facts about the Bible, and in a simple form the lands and localities of the Bible. In churches which use a catechism this should constitute a part of the teaching in the Junior Department, for at this period the child's verbal memory attains its greatest strength.

5. The Intermediate Department. Here the pupils are from twelve to sixteen years of age. The classes should be small, generally of six boys or girls, never more than eight. This period in life is known as early adolescence, and calls for careful direction by wise teachers. In the Intermediate Department the great biographies of the Bible should be studied, either as the regular or the supplemental lessons; also the heroic lives of leaders in the history of the Church, of foreign missionaries, and of men and women who have labored in the home fields. Boys and girls in this stage of life are instinctively hero-worshippers, and before them should be set high ideals of character and service. Special effort should be made in leading the scholars to personal consecration to Christ and to union with the Church; for if the great decision be not made before the age of sixteen is reached, there is great danger that it will never be reached. But that decision should include more than a formal profession. It should embrace a full surrender to the will of Christ, an inward, conscious spiritual life, an aim for completeness of Christian character, and especially a willingness to work for God and humanity. Youth is a season of ardor and of energy, a period of lofty ideals and noble endeavor. All those active powers of the youthful

nature should be guided into channels of usefulness. The true twentieth century disciple of Christ is not one who lives alone feasting his soul on God, but one who stands among his fellow-men, eager to aid in the world's betterment.

6. The Senior Department. This is the preferable title, although some organized schools call it the Young People's Department, and restrict the word Senior to the classes of fully adult age. Still others call it the Assembly, and give it an organization independent of the Sunday school.^[7] The age of entrance should be sixteen, except with some who in stature and mind are mature beyond their years. It is imperative, as we have already seen, that at the door of this department the young people should leave their former teachers, and should not form new Senior classes, but as individuals enter classes already established. This department includes the members of the school between sixteen and twenty years of age; not that members of classes must necessarily leave them at twenty, but that men or women above that age entering the school should rather join the Adult Department. The classes may be as large as the arrangement of rooms will allow; larger where each class can have a separate room, which is the ideal plan. Generally, young men and young women should be in separate classes. The teacher of a young men's class should be a man whose character will inspire the respect and win the fellowship of his class. The teacher of the young women's class will generally be a lady, although often men have been successful teachers of young women.

In this department the classes should be organized, each with its own officers, chosen by the members; and the class should be consulted when a teacher is to be appointed, although the voice of the class in the decision should be advisory and not mandatory. Especial attention should be given to the social activities of this department. Each class should have its own gatherings, classes of young men and women should meet together occasionally, and a Senior Reception should be held at least annually to promote acquaintance among the members. The interest of the young people should also be enlisted in some definite form of service for the church or the community.

7. The Teacher-Training Department. The most promising young people, both men and women, should be selected at sixteen years of age—

the time of promotion into the Senior Department—and should be organized as the Teacher-training or Normal Class. The best teacher obtainable should be assigned to this department. Often in the high school or some near-by college, a scholarly, Bible-loving instructor may be found who is willing to give a part of his time to the equipment of teachers for the coming generation. A text-book should be chosen from among those approved by the International Teacher-training Committee. No person should be admitted to this class who is not willing to give some time during the week to the study of the course. While the rest of the school may be studying the regular lessons, whether graded or uniform, this class should be at work with the teacher-training text-books. There should be thorough instruction with examinations looking toward a certificate of work done, such as the International Teacher-training diploma.^[8] The course may cover two, three, or four years; and new members may be placed in the class at the opening of each year, to begin at the point where the class is studying, and to remain until they shall have completed the entire course. In a properly graded school after a few years there will be a class graduating from and a class entering the Teacher-training Department each year.

This department should also include a Reserve Class, consisting of those who are ready to act as substitutes for absent teachers. If the uniform lessons are followed, the Reserve Class should study the lesson a week in advance of the school. Into this class the graduates of the Teacher-training Class should be placed, to remain until classes are ready for them in the school.

In some schools the Teacher-training and Reserve Classes do not form a separate department, but are two classes in the Senior Department. But it is the better plan in a large school to establish the Teacher-training Department, with its own officers, thereby adding to its prestige in the school.

8. The Adult Department. This will include all who are above the age of twenty years. It is the judgment of advanced leaders in Sunday-school work that at twenty years those who have belonged to Young People's classes in the Senior Department should leave them for the Adult Department. Otherwise, the Senior Department in a few years will cease to be a place where young people of sixteen and eighteen years feel at home.

In the Adult Department men and women may meet together as members of the same class, unless there arise a demand for separate classes and the numbers enrolled justify the division. In conducting these classes two forms of instruction have been found to be successful: (1) the colloquial method of teaching, the class studying and discussing the lesson together under the guidance of the leader; and (2) the lecture method, the teacher being the principal speaker, but always admitting questions and answers on the subject suggested by the lesson. Classes in this department may be allowed to choose their own courses of study, provided (1) that the subjects and methods are in line with the general aim of religious education, and not merely secular science or history; (2) that the courses of successive years have some sequence, and are not chosen in a haphazard, accidental manner. The Adult Department under wise direction should promote a large, intelligent, broad-minded, philanthropic type of Christian character in the church and the community.

9. The Home Department. This department, like the Cradle Roll at the other extreme of the Sunday-school constituency, is composed of people, both young and old, who cannot be present at its sessions, but are interested in its work, and willing to give some time to its studies. In every community there are such people—aged or infirm men and women, invalids, mothers unable to leave their offspring, commercial travelers, and people who live too far from the school to attend it. These are organized into the Home Department, furnished with the literature of the school, study its text-books, make their report of work done, and send their contributions to its support through the Home Department superintendent or visitor.[\[9\]](#)

VI

THE SUPERINTENDENT

1. **His Importance.** Several years ago, the president of the New York Central Railway was called upon by a legislative committee to explain the system of signals employed upon the railroad for the protection of passengers. He gave a detailed statement, answered every question, and then made this remark: "However perfect the system may seem to be, there must always be a man to work it; and in the final analysis more depends on the man than on the plan."

That which is true in every human organization is especially true in the Sunday school: its success depends not on a constitution, whether written or unwritten, but upon a man. In the Sunday school that man is the superintendent, who not only works the plan, but also generally plans the work. Given an efficient superintendent, an efficient school will usually be developed; for the able man will call forth or will train up able workers. Hence the first and greatest requisite for a successful Sunday school is that the right man be chosen as superintendent.

2. **His Appointment.** The selection of the superintendent should be the task not only of the officers and teachers in the Sunday school, but of the entire church, for every family in the congregation has an interest in his appointment. The pastor should be consulted, and should give diligent attention and time to the search for a superintendent, not merely because he may be presumed to know his constituency, but more especially because out of all the church the superintendent is to be his most important helper. The election of the superintendent should be made by the workers in the school, its board of teachers and officers, and its action should be formally confirmed by the ruling board of the local church. No man should hold the office of a superintendent who fails to receive the approval of the church of which the school is a part. He should know that in his appointment the school, the church, and the pastor all unite.

3. His Term of Office. He should be chosen for a term of one year; but may be reëlected for as many terms as appear expedient. Frequent changes in the management of the school will tend to destroy the efficiency of its work. But whenever the great interests involved in the religious education of an entire church or community require a new superintendent the change should be made, even though sympathy be felt for the one set aside. The institution must not be sacrificed to save the feelings of the man.

4. His Qualifications. It is important to consider the qualifications of an ideal superintendent, remembering, however, that all these qualities are rarely to be found in one man. We must set before us high ideals, not expecting that they will always be fully realized, yet ever seeking to attain them as far as may be possible in this imperfect world. The following are the most important qualifications for a superintendent; some of them are essential, all are desirable:

(1) *Moral Character.* The Sunday school undertakes to train the young in character; therefore he who stands as its responsible head must possess a character worthy of admiration and imitation. His life must honor, and not dishonor, his profession. It is possible for a man whose work for an hour on Sunday is in behalf of the gospel so to live in his family, in business, and in society as to work for six days against the gospel, and more than undo all his efforts for good. The leader in such an uplifting movement as the Sunday school must have clean hands and a pure heart. What Saint Paul wrote of a bishop he would have written of a Sunday school superintendent: he must have "a good report." In the well-known painting of the Emancipation Proclamation may be seen standing at the right hand of President Lincoln the Secretary of the Treasury, Salmon P. Chase, who once said, "A man in my position must not only seem right, but be right; and not only be right, but seem right." So will every one say of the Sunday-school superintendent.

(2) *A Devout Believer.* The superintendent's character should be irradiated with the fine glow of a Christian faith. He should be one who has seen the heavenly vision and unto it has not been disobedient; one whose spirit has been kindled by the Divine Spirit burning like a fire within; one who is himself a Christian man, longing to lead other men into fellowship with the Father through Jesus Christ the Son.

(3) *A Working Church Member.* We have already learned that the Sunday school is not a society or an institution standing alone. It is a branch of the church, and one of the most important branches. The normal growth of the church depends in large measure upon the Sunday school, and the support of the Sunday school comes, or should come, from the church. The superintendent who endeavors to do his duty to his scholars will strive to lead them to Christ and into active membership and service in the church. Therefore, he himself must be a professed, loyal, and effective member of the church. His name should not only stand upon its roll, but his heart should also be enlisted in its behalf.

(4) *A Bible Student.* The Sunday school is the school with one preëminent text-book; and of that Book the superintendent should be a diligent student. His work is executive and not instructional; yet he must supervise the teaching, and this supervision he cannot rightly give unless he is familiar with the course of study. He should study the lesson of each department, perhaps not as thoroughly as the teachers in the department, but sufficiently to maintain acquaintance with their work. And he should master not only the specific lessons of the immediate course before his school, but also the Book as a whole.

One successful superintendent gave as a secret of his power to make his school, both teachers and scholars, willing to do whatever he asked, "I never expect my teachers or scholars to do anything that I am not ready to do myself. Before I ask them to bring their Bibles I bring mine. When I asked my school to be ready on the following Sunday to repeat in concert the Nineteenth Psalm, I committed it to memory during the week, and when the time came spoke the words with the school." Only that superintendent who himself loves the Bible, and studies it, can have a true Bible school.

(5) *An Able Executive.* The Sunday school is like that vision seen by the prophet Ezekiel, a system of wheels within wheels, all endowed with life; and the master of the mechanism directing its motion is the superintendent. Moreover, each of these living wheels in the Sunday-school machine is a volunteer worker, who may at any moment drop out of his orbit. To hold together these varied elements, to combine their movements, to guide each in his own sphere, to compass the common purpose through all the forces working as one, requires a wise brain and a skillful hand. The

superintendent should have a plan for the school, with details throughout for every emergency; he should be ready to assign to every worker the task for which he is best fitted; he should be able to work with others, not merely to command others; and he should be a leader whom others will follow, not by the might of an overmastering will, but by the magnetism of an attractive personality. He should never forget that with others as well as with himself service in the Sunday school is not compulsory but voluntary, that his associates lay on the altar their free-hearted, unpaid labor; and that such workers cannot be commanded, although by tact and wise generalship they may be led to accomplish the most difficult tasks.

(6) *Sympathy with Youth.* The superintendent's office will bring him into relations with youth during all its stages, from early childhood through the entire adolescent period. He must be able to see life and the world through the eyes of a little child, of a growing boy, and of a young man. The sympathy which he needs is not a compassionate feeling *for* youth, but a feeling *with* youth, an ability to put himself in its place; to feel as young people feel, and to understand why they act as they sometimes do. This sympathy will impart a love for young people, such a love as will enable him to be patient with their foibles and faults, to exert a powerful influence over them, and to keep before them noble ideals of character and service.

(7) *Teachable Spirit.* No matter how much the superintendent knows, or thinks he knows, he should hold his mind open to new knowledge. He should be on the alert for new ideas, from the periodicals, from books, and from his fellow workers, in conversation, at conventions and institutes; not that he may inflict every new method upon his school, but that out of many methods he may select the best. When Michael Angelo was past eighty-five years old, and almost blind, he was found one day beside an antique torso which had recently been dug out of the ground, bending over it, and carefully pressing his fingers upon its surface. When asked what he was doing, he answered, "I am learning"! The masters in every department of work are never too wise nor too old to learn.

If a man can be found who possesses all these seven traits of character and temperament, the school which can secure him for its superintendent will be fortunate indeed. And the superintendent who thoughtfully reads the catalogue of qualifications, and feels that in some of them he is lacking,

may by divine grace and his own will working together make progress toward the goal of becoming an ideal superintendent.

VII

THE SUPERINTENDENT'S DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

The superintendent has been found, has been chosen, and is in his place—what are the prerogatives and the duties of his office? These may be considered under three classes: (1) His general duties. (2) His duties during the week. (3) His duties in the session of the school.

1. **General.** (1) *Supervision.* It is his right to supervise and direct the work of the school without interference as to details from the teachers, the officers of the church, or the pastor. The pastor may be the admiral of the fleet, directing the general movements of the sea campaign; but the superintendent is the captain of the ship, through whom orders are to be given to all on board.

(2) *Selection of Teachers.* He should have the chief word in the choice and appointment of teachers, but in the choice he should obtain the concurrence of his pastor; and their election should be made upon the superintendent's nomination by the teachers and officers.

(3) *Assignment of Scholars.* He should possess the final authority in the assignment of scholars to classes, in any changes from class to class, and in promotions from lower to higher departments. In these responsibilities he may be greatly aided by an associate superintendent, to whom his authority may be delegated.

(4) *Program of Services.* It is the superintendent's prerogative to plan and direct the services of the school session. It may be the part of wisdom for him to consult with the musical director or organist in the selection of hymns, but it is the superintendent's right to choose and to announce them, in common with all parts of the program.

(5) *Support.* He is entitled to a loyal support from all his fellow workers; but if he is tactful he will take them into his confidence, will present his plans for their consideration, and will not attempt important reforms or changes without their concurrence.

2. **Week-day Work.** He is the superintendent of the Sunday school for seven days in every week; and will find much work to be done between the sessions. His week-day duties will include some that have already been mentioned.

(1) *Program.* Before he comes to the school he should invariably prepare a well worked out program for each session. It is a good plan to have a large blank book, in which two pages opposite each other are assigned to the session for the day. Every hymn should be selected in advance and noted in its place; every announcement to be made should be written; the outline of a lesson review, if one is to be given, should be indicated; and space should be left for memoranda of miscellaneous matters which may need attention. This program should be laid upon the desk, so that if for any reason the superintendent should be out of his place upon the platform an associate can go forward without delay.

(2) *Lesson Study.* In schools where the uniform lesson is still followed in all or most departments, the superintendent should make himself thoroughly acquainted with the lesson for the coming session. As has been intimated, he should be prepared for any work expected of his teachers and scholars. He should be ready after the class study to give a practical summary of the teachings in the lesson, in a crisp, well-outlined talk, which will be aided by a blackboard illustration. And in the increasing number of schools which are employing graded lessons, not uniform in the departments, the superintendent should have at least a general knowledge of the subjects studied in each department. The more thoroughly the superintendent fills his own mind and heart with the truth, the more efficiently will the truth be taught in his school.

(3) *Social Duties.* The superintendent should know all his teachers, and, as far as possible, his scholars also. If it be practicable for him to visit teachers at their homes, the visitation will greatly increase his influence and his usefulness. If in his own home, or in the parlors of some family in the

congregation, a social gathering of the teachers and officers can occasionally be held, it will add to the social power of the school. And in the social relations much can be accomplished before and after the church service, the school session, the prayer meeting, and the other gatherings of the congregation. There are superintendents who keep before them up-to-date lists of the classes, and by study of faces during the school session, with judicious inquiry, are able to call large numbers of the scholars by name. Such greetings will strengthen the superintendent and heighten the loyalty of the school.

(4) *Seeking Workers.* In nearly all Sunday schools there is a constant need of helpers, to fill the places of withdrawing or absent teachers; and the work of supplying the demand generally falls upon the superintendent. He may find relief in the work of an associate superintendent, as will be seen in the next chapter. Both the superintendent and his associate should always be on the alert for new teachers and for new scholars. As the builder in stone looks at every fragment of rock, to see where it will best fit into his wall, so the whole-hearted superintendent studies every individual in the parish, to find exactly the place he may fill in the school, as an officer, a teacher, or a scholar; and not infrequently his search will be rewarded by a treasure.

(5) *Cabinet Meetings.* The superintendent should confer frequently with the several heads of departments, and with all the officers; talking with them freely about his own plans, and learning theirs, for the welfare of the school. It is not necessary that these cabinet meetings should be formal, having a secretary and a record. They may be held occasionally, for a few minutes after the session of the school, or as a social evening at a private house.

(6) *Special Days.* He should keep a calendar of special occasions in the school year, such as the Sundays set apart for temperance and for missions, Easter, Children's Day, Rally Day, Decision Day, Christmas, Promotion Day, and other notable events. Weeks in advance of each occasion—in the case of some of them even months in advance—he should begin to consider what special exercises should be held, what preparation is needed, and who can best supervise the plans. For a fortnight before Children's Day or the Christmas celebration, many Sunday schools are in a turmoil of confusion,

and lessons abandoned, simply because the superintendent did not take thought in sufficient time.

(7) *The Convention.* The Sunday-school work of the Christian world is now thoroughly organized in international, state, county, and town associations. Each school finds itself a part in a mighty movement; and it is the duty of the superintendent to see that his school takes its place in the Sunday-school army. He should see that in the institute and the convention his school is well represented; and if at all possible he should attend these gatherings, and be active in them. Many a worker who for most of the year is alone, burdened with perplexities, has been refreshed, has found his vision enlarged and his plans improved, by conference with other workers, and by listening to experienced specialists.

3. His Duties in the School Session. (1) *Present Early.* He should be at his post, if possible, from twenty minutes to half an hour before the opening of the school. However early he may arrive, he will probably find a group of children there in advance of him; and they will behave better if his eye is on them, especially if his glance is kind, and with it is a hand-shake or a word of recognition. The early superintendent will often be surprised to find how much business in the interest of the school can be transacted before the session.

(2) *Open Promptly.* With his program ready, he should begin the session exactly on the minute, and should carry out every item according to the plan. If for any reason the superintendent is not at the desk when the moment for the opening arrives, the associate or first department superintendent should be empowered to call the school to order and begin the opening service.

(3) *Conduct Program.* The superintendent should conduct the general program of services; although it is advisable to recognize the associate and others, by calling upon them to take some part in the opening or closing services. A superintendent whose methods were always well chosen was wont once in each month to invite some official or prominent member of the church, who was not an attendant upon the school, to be present, sit upon the platform, and offer the prayer at the opening of the session. This kept the leading members of the church in closer relation to the school.

(4) *During the Lesson.* As a general principle, the superintendent should remain at his desk during the lesson period; but to this rule frequent exceptions will be made. The supply of substitutes for absent teachers, and the assignment of new scholars to classes, belong to the field of the associate superintendent.

(5) *Lesson Review.* In the Sunday schools which still follow the uniform system of lessons, studying the same portion of Scripture in all, or nearly all, the grades of the school, the superintendent should give a brief practical summing up of the practical points in the lesson; but this review should not exceed five or six minutes in length. If the pastor possesses the gift of terse, crisp speaking, this practical talk may be given by him. In the schools adopting the graded courses of lessons this review should be given in each department by the department superintendent. Here again the adaptation to the point of view and needs of the pupils of each grade can be made much more effective than in the ungraded school.

(6) *Closing.* The superintendent should so carry out the program as to close the session at the time appointed. An hour and a quarter is as long as is profitable for the school; and everything that needs to be done can be brought into that space. Often much time is lost by unnecessary delays between the numbers on the program.

4. Miscellaneous Duties. Here are a few general suggestions, hints, and "don'ts" for the superintendent, briefly stated:

(1) *Notebook.* Let the superintendent remember to obtain that notebook, to keep it at hand, and to make use of it. Some pages at the end of the book might be reserved for special suggestions gathered from books, periodicals, and meetings.

(2) *Quiet.* Let him be careful not to make much noise during the session, but to set an example—which will soon be felt—in favor of quiet and orderly conduct. It is not at all certain that he needs a bell for calling attention; but if he uses one, let it be a little, gentle, quiet bell, held in the hand as a signal, and never rung vociferously or repeatedly. Said a new superintendent as he tested the bell on Saturday before assuming office, "What a magnificent bell this would be for calling missionaries home from India!" But he never used it in the school. One of the best superintendents

of a generation ago was widely known as "the silent superintendent." He was not deaf nor dumb, but his manner was noticeably quiet, and his large Sunday school was always in perfect order.

(3) *Early Lesson.* Let the opening service be short, so that the lesson period—which is the important part of the program—may be reached while the teachers and scholars are fresh and the air of the room is pure.

(4) *Use the Bible.* If a Scripture lesson is read by the superintendent and school responsively, it should be from the Bible upon the desk or in the hand of the leader, and not from a lesson quarterly. Encourage the use of the Bible as a text-book and for reference. If the superintendent always brings his own Bible, he can appeal to his teachers and scholars to follow his example. With regard to the Scripture reading in the opening service, it is the judgment of many thoughtful superintendents that even in a school following uniform lessons the reading should not be the lesson for the day, but a devotional portion of Scripture, perhaps a selection from the Home Readings of the week. It is a good plan for the first reading of the lesson for the day to be by the teacher and the class together.

(5) *Lesson Period.* No interruption should be allowed to break into the time assigned for class study, except under imperative necessity. The teacher and the class should hold that period sacred to united study, without being diverted from their task by secretary, librarian, superintendent, or pastor. Said Bishop Vincent once, "I would like to have suspended from the roof of the Sunday-school hall a series of great glass half-globes, one for each class, to be dropped down over the class, and kept there during the time reserved for the study of the lesson!"

(6) *Speakers.* A visitor should rarely be invited or allowed to address the school; never, unless the superintendent has sufficient knowledge to be sure that he will speak briefly, interestingly, and pointedly. Before the uniform lesson concentrated the studies of the Sunday school it was the custom to invite almost any visitor to speak to the school; and many were the wrongs inflicted upon the boys and girls in those good old days by dull, loquacious Sunday-school orators. But almost everybody now understands that the Sunday school is a working institution, and its work must not be interrupted.

(7) *Self-control.* There will be times when the superintendent will need to be on guard over himself; times when he feels depressed, or melancholy, perhaps a little cross. If he yields to his natural impulses, the school will soon perceive the state of his nerves, and some scholars may even endeavor to add to his trials. At such times, let him watch over himself mightily, and resolve, no matter how he feels, to "keep sweet," to speak gently, and to look cheerful.

(8) *The Aim.* Lastly, one purpose should ever stand before the superintendent, and should be the constant object of his endeavor—to lead all his scholars into a personal, vital relation to Jesus as the Christ, to bring them into union with the church, and to inspire them to enter upon active Christian service.

VIII

THE ASSOCIATE AND DEPARTMENT SUPERINTENDENTS

1. **The Necessity.** In every Sunday school there is need of an officer to aid the superintendent and to take his place when absent. Even in a small school the supervision can be more thorough and the teaching more efficient, if some one is at hand with authority to relieve the superintendent of minor details, and give him freedom for the general management. And in a large school assistants to the superintendent are an absolute necessity, for each department becomes in itself a school. There is need, therefore, of a general assistant to be the chief of staff to the superintendent, and, in a large and well-organized school, of a special assistant in each department.

2. **Titles.** Until recently, the assistant superintendent in most Sunday schools was merely one of the teachers named to take the place of the superintendent when absent, but with no duties when the head of the school was present. In the complete organization that is now becoming general, the office has been renamed, and its functions distinctly assigned. The chief assistant to the superintendent is now generally called the Associate Superintendent, a higher title for his important and regular duties. The chief of each department in the Sunday school is generally called Department Superintendent, that is, Primary Department Superintendent, Senior Department Superintendent; and each department superintendent has the same relation to his department that the associate superintendent holds to the school.

3. **Appointment.** The associate superintendent should be nominated by the superintendent and confirmed by the board of teachers and officers. When two candidates are nominated for the office of superintendent, and one obtains a majority, it is not wise to elect the minority candidate as associate superintendent, unless he is entirely acceptable to the newly chosen superintendent. The chief executive of the school should not be

compelled to find next to him a rival, who may be an uncongenial worker, to carry out plans with which the latter may not be in accord. In order to possess freedom in his policy the superintendent should choose his own chief helper; but he should receive the confirmation of his choice from his fellow workers in the school. The same plan of nomination and confirmation should be followed in the choice of the department superintendents. The associate and the department superintendents should constitute the superintendent's cabinet, to be called together often for consultation upon the interests of the school.

4. Duties of the Associate Superintendent. (1) *Not a Teacher.* Unless the school be small, with less than a hundred members, the associate superintendent should not at the same time be the regular teacher of a class. He will find other work to occupy his time, both before and during the session of the school. He may, however, hold himself ready to act as substitute for an absent teacher.

(2) *Deputy Superintendent.* If for any reason the superintendent is absent, his place should be taken promptly by the associate superintendent. It should also be understood that if at the moment of opening the school, or at any point in the general service, the superintendent is not on the platform, the associate shall act as his representative, without the slightest reflection upon the superintendent's administration, the two being regarded in their work as one.

(3) *Providing Substitutes.* One definite duty of the associate superintendent should be to provide substitutes for absent teachers, relieving entirely the superintendent from that burdensome and perplexing task. The teachers should permit no ordinary hindrance to keep them from their classes, for no one can fully supply the place of a true teacher in the regard of the scholars. But when a teacher finds it necessary to be absent he should make strenuous endeavor to find a substitute; and if unable to secure one, should notify, not the superintendent, but the associate; and before the lesson period the associate should have a supply ready.

If the school has been properly graded it will include a Teacher-training Class; but under no circumstances should the associate take one of its members as a supply teacher, even for one Sunday. This class should remain

untouched by the demand for teachers until its members have completed the prescribed course. If there is a Reserve Class, substitutes should be called from it in some order, preferably alphabetical, so that the same members will not be taken too frequently.

Where the Sunday school is held in the afternoon or at noon, the associate can generally provide for needy classes by watching at the morning service for possible teachers. If he is compelled to look for them in the Adult or Senior classes of the school, he should be present early, and if possible obtain his supplies before the opening of the school. If the associate superintendent has done his work, when the lesson begins, every class will have a teacher seated before it, ready for the Bible study. He should never wait until the time for opening the lesson to see what classes need teachers, and then undertake to obtain them by interrupting the teaching in three or four classes and calling for volunteers, while the classes without teachers are listlessly waiting, and valuable time is lost from the half-hour of the lesson period. All this work should be done before the lesson, and, if possible, before the opening of the school.

(4) *Assignment of New Scholars.* Another duty of the associate superintendent is to meet new scholars and assign them to classes. For this work he should be present early, meet the scholars as they come, learn who the new scholars are, write down names, places of residence, ages, parents' names, why they come; and prepare material for the card catalogue under the secretary's care. Scholars bringing new members, and teachers into whose classes they may come, should introduce them to the associate superintendent, who should at once take charge of them. No new scholar below the grade of Senior should choose his own class, although his desire to be with friends should be considered, so far as it will not interfere with the established system of classification. Some large graded schools have a temporary class to which new pupils in the Intermediate and Junior grades are assigned for a few sessions until their permanent place can be fixed.

(5) *Detailed Supervision.* There are also minor duties wherein the associate superintendent can be of great service. While the superintendent is at the desk directing the general exercises, his associate may be upon the floor, quietly observing the condition and needs of the school. He can note where Bibles, song books, or lesson quarterlies are needed, and can see that

they are distributed without interrupting the service. He can also give quiet attention to the order of the school, calling to their duty boisterous, talking, or inattentive scholars. For the superintendent to stop in announcing a hymn or reading the Scripture, to rebuke some disorderly or thoughtless pupil, breaks into the service and mars its dignity. The associate superintendent can accomplish the desired result at the right moment by a light step and a gentle word.

(6) *Chief of Staff.* In a word, the associate superintendent should be the chief of staff to the executive head of the school, his eyes, ears, and hand; possessing full acquaintance and accord with his plans, and carrying them out in his name; informing and advising him, yet careful of criticism; avoiding all that would hinder, and aiding in all that would make his management successful. He can divide the labor, and relieve his chief of some of the most perplexing and trying details, leaving him free to watch over the general interests of the school. Whoever can fulfill such a service is an invaluable worker, and should be held in high honor.

Many of the duties named above may be in the sphere of the department superintendent, who should be in his section what the associate superintendent is to the school.

IX

THE SECRETARY OF THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

1. **Importance.** The secretary of the Sunday school is an officer of far greater importance than is generally supposed. In too many schools some youth in the adolescent period is made secretary, merely to keep him in the school, without consideration of his capacity and adaptedness to the office. As a result of an unsuitable appointment, the minutes of the teachers' meetings are incomplete, the registry of the classes is neglected, and the true condition of the school cannot be ascertained. If by any good fortune or by a more careful choice an able and faithful secretary takes his place, at once a new impulse is felt by the school. The superintendent, the teachers, and even the scholars will realize that energy, accuracy, and thoroughness count for much in the work of this department. They will appreciate faithful service, and will themselves respond to its influence.

2. **Qualifications.** The ideal secretary of a Sunday school should possess the following characteristics:

(1) *A Business Man.* He should possess the instincts of a man of business, being willing to work, systematic in method, and thorough in care of details.

(2) *Regular in Attendance.* He should make the Sunday school his business on Sunday, with a fidelity equal to that which he manifests toward his vocation through the week. His regularity should also embrace promptness, coming in advance of the hour; for much of the secretary's work may be done before the opening of the service.

(3) *Good Writer.* He should be able to write legibly, and possess skill in framing sentences correctly, and in writing them plainly, without unnecessary flourishes.

(4) *Quick Mental Action.* His mental processes should be sufficiently rapid for him to set down an ordinary motion, presented in a public meeting, without requiring it to be repeated or written out by the mover. An able recorder will promptly express in the minutes the form of a motion or the spirit of a speech, thereby saving much time in the meeting and much space in the report.

(5) *Quiet Manner.* The secretary should watch the program and do his work without interrupting it. He should never appear among the classes during prayer, during the reading of Scripture, or while a speaker is addressing the school. Only under urgent necessity should he come to a class in the lesson period, and in that case only at its beginning. During intervals in the service, or during the singing, he may find it needful at times to pass among the classes; but he should do this necessary work quietly, without distracting the attention of the school.

(6) *Courteous Conduct.* His bearing should always be that of a gentleman, refined and courteous, thoughtful of others and patient toward all; a manner enabling him to win the friendly aid of every teacher, upon whom the accuracy of the class record must depend.

Whoever can be found, in the school or the community, possessing these qualities, or approaching them, should be chosen as secretary of the Sunday school, whether man or woman. Often a young woman, accustomed through the week to business methods, becomes an efficient secretary of the Sunday school.

3. **Appointment.** The secretary should be elected by the board of officers and teachers. As he is not merely an assistant to the superintendent, but an officer of the school, it is not necessary that he should receive a nomination from the superintendent. His term of office should be one year, with as many reëlections as will promote the good of the service.

4. **Assistants.** In almost any school the secretary will need an assistant, whom he should nominate, subject to confirmation by the board of teachers and officers.

5. **Department Secretaries.** In a graded Sunday school there should be an assistant secretary for each department, who may be one of the teachers,

or in the Senior and Adult grades, one of the scholars. He should take the records of the classes in the department and transmit them to the secretary of the school. But the secretary is responsible for the records of the entire school, and should see personally that the record of each department is complete.

6 . Duties. The work of the secretary may be classified as follows:

(1) *Record of Meetings.* As secretary of the board of teachers and officers, he should be present at all business meetings and make a careful record. Every motion should be stated clearly, with the names of its mover and its seconder, and the action taken. A statement should be given of every committee appointed, its purpose, and the names of its members. All committees should be expected to present written reports, however brief. A concise summary of each report, in a few sentences, or a single clause, should appear in the minutes of the meeting at which the report is presented; and the report itself should be filed for reference in case it should be needed. A committee once named is on the minutes, and cannot be ignored nor forgotten until its report has been presented and adopted, and the committee has been formally discharged. For example, it is not sufficient for the committee on the Christmas entertainment to hold the entertainment; it must afterward report that the entertainment was held on a certain date; must have its report adopted, and receive its discharge. It should be the duty of the secretary from time to time to call for reports of committees named in the minutes of previous meetings, to insist that a report be rendered, and that some action be taken upon it.

(2) *Record of the School.* In every well-ordered Sunday school the secretary summarizes in writing the attendance in each department, the total attendance, the number of new scholars, and other items to be preserved, including the weather, which may sometimes account for a small attendance; also a comparison with the record of the same Sunday last year. This report should be read to the school by the secretary at the call of the superintendent, or posted before the school; and it should also be recorded in a book which will contain the statistics of the school through a term of years.

(3) *Records of Classes.* The secretary and his assistants should prepare the books in which the class record of attendance is recorded. The name of each scholar should be given correctly and fully (for example, not "F. Jones," but "Frederick Jones"). The secretary should see that the record of attendance for each Sunday is accurately kept. He will need to give special attention to classes where substitutes take the place of absent teachers, and to see that the record for the day is not neglected. As often as the arrangement of the class books requires the rewriting of the names of the scholars, he should transcribe the list, always writing every name in full. In looking through the class lists he should note the names of those who have been absent for a series of sessions, and should report them to the superintendent, for consideration and for investigation of every habitual absentee. If these scholars can be visited, many of them may be retained in the school.

(4) *Records of Scholars.* In addition to the record in the class books, another record should be kept of every member of the school, including every officer, teacher, and scholar; a card catalogue, each name upon a separate card, and all the cards filed in alphabetical order. The card for each scholar should give besides his name the date of his entrance to the school, either the date of his birth or his age at entering—approximative, if above eighteen years; his residence, with street and number in a city; parents' names; class to which he is assigned; his relation to the church or congregation, and any other important facts. The card should contain the record of every promotion, and its date; of any changes in residence, and other details, so that it becomes a reliable and complete history of each individual in the school. In many schools the birthday of each member is kept upon the record, and is recognized by sending a birthday card. If a scholar or teacher leaves the school the fact is recorded, and the card is then taken from the regular catalogue and filed permanently in the list of "former members."

(5) *Literature of the School.* The secretary should be in charge of the literature used by the school, its text-books, lesson-quarterlies, and other periodicals. He should see that the literature is ordered in full time, should receive it, keep it in his care, and attend to its distribution. The particular text-book for each grade is fixed by the superintendent; and the secretary should receive from him direction as to the lesson helps for each grade.

(6) *Correspondence.* The secretary should conduct all correspondence in behalf of the school or of the teachers as a body, unless for a special purpose the chairman of a committee be in charge of correspondence relating to his work.

The secretary who with the aid of his staff undertakes to do all the work that rises before him will not find his task a light one. But his department carried on with vigor will greatly promote the success of the Sunday school.

X

THE TREASURY AND THE TREASURER

1. **In the Early Sunday School.** A study of origins has shown that in the earliest Sunday schools in America, as in England, provision was made for the payment of officers and teachers. In the first schools established in and near Philadelphia, each paid teacher had charge of what would now be considered a department, and the practical teaching was given under his direction by scholars, who were called monitors. But in a new country, where the settlements were small and the people mostly poor, the system of paid teachers soon passed away, and the schools were carried on by voluntary and unpaid workers. It was fortunate for the American Sunday school that in its beginnings it required but little money. For the place of meeting any chapel or schoolhouse or settler's cabin would serve. The literature was exceedingly meager—a few Testaments and spelling books, and generally these were brought by the teachers and scholars. When the earliest lesson books were published, they were not quarterlies, nor annuals, to be thrown away after one using, but were studied year after year. The largest item of expense was the library; and as this was an institution for the entire neighborhood, the families willingly contributed toward it. Not until the Sunday school had become thoroughly founded did the question of its financial support arise as a problem.

2. **In the Modern Sunday School.** As the Sunday school advanced in position, in influence, and in better methods of work, its expenses naturally increased. Now, in the opening of its second century, its financial requirements are far greater than they were even a generation ago. It asks for special and suitable buildings, with rooms and furnishings adapted to the educational needs of its several departments; for a periodical literature suited to teachers and scholars of every grade, and requiring to be renewed every year; for an organ or piano—often for several, with an orchestra added; for an equipment of song books different from those in the church service; for entertainments and gifts at Christmas, and a day's outing for all

in the summer; for libraries containing popular books for the scholars and helpful works for the teachers in their work. The demands of a large and growing Sunday school, in city or country, are great, but in nearly all congregations the funds for the support of the Sunday school are obtained with less effort than those for any other department of church activity, and in this liberality the Christian people show their wisdom and insight.

3. Practical Ways and Means. The methods of financial support for the Sunday school are exceedingly varied. The simplest plan is through a regular weekly contribution in the classes. Where attention is given to the collection, and an appeal is occasionally made in its behalf, the school will generally obtain the funds needed for its own support. When the special need arises for the purchase of a piano or a library, some entertainment may be held which will by its profits swell the receipts. The objection to these methods, which are almost universal, is that they appeal to self-interest, and fail to educate the members of the school in true liberality. It is for *our* school, *our* piano, *our* library, that the appeal is made and the money is contributed. The scholars should be taught to give to the cause of Christ and his gospel, and not merely to interests from which they themselves are to receive a reward.

4. The Ideal Way of Giving. The more excellent way is for the church in its annual estimate of expenses to include a fair, even liberal, allowance for the Sunday school, and at intervals through the year pass over to the treasury of the Sunday school the funds appropriated, to be expended according to principles and regulations provided. Then let every officer, teacher, and pupil in the school, from the Adult Department to the Primary, and even to the Beginners, make his own weekly offering to the church. Most church schools contribute to the cause of foreign missions; but there is equal reason why they should give to all the general benevolent objects for which the church receives an annual collection. This plan would unite the church and the school more firmly, would avoid multiplying and conflicting objects for which funds are raised, and, best of all, would train every child in the Sunday school to systematic giving upon the true gospel principle, which is "not to be ministered unto, but to minister."

5. The Sunday-School Treasurer. The work of the treasurer is very different from that of the secretary; yet the two offices are often held by one

person. In that case they should be regarded as distinct positions; the election to the two offices should be separate, and not at the same time for one person as secretary and treasurer. At every business meeting a separate report should be presented for the two departments, and the treasurership should not be regarded as a branch of the secretary's work. If the plan outlined in the last paragraph be adopted as the method of providing for the financial needs of the Sunday school, it might be well to choose the treasurer of the church as treasurer of the Sunday school, thus giving unity to the financial administration of the entire organization.

6. The Treasurer's Work. This will require a person who is known as careful in accounts, as well as honorable in all his dealings.

(1) *His Charge.* All the funds of the Sunday school should pass through his hands. If money is raised for any purpose, or a money-making entertainment is held, the treasurer should take charge of the receipts and pay the bills. For this purpose he should be ex officio a member of all committees required to receive and disburse funds.

(2) *Bank Account.* Except in small and remote places, the treasurer will find it desirable to keep an account with a bank in behalf of the school, and deposit therein all moneys received. Under no circumstances should he deposit Sunday-school funds as a part of his own private account, but should keep separate accounts as an individual and as treasurer.

(3) *Reports and Vouchers.* At each meeting of the governing board of the school he should present a statement of the condition of the treasury, with exact mention of all moneys received and paid since the last meeting; and for every payment he should show a receipt or voucher, and on it the "O. K." or approval of some qualified person who knows that it is correct.

(4) *Bills.* He should receive all bills against the school, and should inform himself concerning them, in order to be able to answer any questions raised by members of the board. He should present at the meeting a statement of all the unpaid bills on hand, with a forecast of bills expected, and obtain a vote of the board upon each bill that is to be paid.

(5) *Checks.* It is desirable to pay bills as far as possible with checks, as the check will often serve as a receipt; and the receipted bills should be

filed together for reference.

(6) *Audits.* An Auditing Committee should be appointed, to examine the accounts of the school from time to time, and always when the treasurer completes his term, alike whether he is reëlected or gives place to a successor. This committee should either present a written report, or should sign their names to the treasurer's report, with the indorsement, "Audited and found correct."

Most of the above recommendations, perhaps all of them, state the methods that would be followed by any intelligent, businesslike treasurer. But in the continent-wide area of the Sunday school, of necessity, not all treasurers are intelligent or experienced in business methods; and there are doubtless many who may profit by these suggestions.

(7) *Study of Benevolent Interests.* One of the most important duties of a treasurer in a modern Sunday school is to study the different charitable objects that present themselves to the school, decide upon their merits, and then present them understandingly to the members of the school, with a view to eliciting their interest and training them in the spirit and habit of intelligent giving. This important task raises the treasurership out of mere mechanical service, and constitutes it one of the directing forces in the school.

XI

VALUE OF THE SUNDAY-SCHOOL LIBRARY

1. **The Library of the Past.** Until quite recent times the Sunday-school library was understood to be a collection of books, mainly of an entertaining character, kept in the school, distributed at its sessions, and read by the scholars, for enjoyment rather than for instruction. Such a library was regarded as an essential of the Sunday school. However small or however poor the school, it must have a library. Books were scarce, and desirable books were high in price. There were no free public libraries, and few circulating libraries. The library was regarded as the principal attraction of the school, and it drew the scholars. Many children attended two Sunday schools in order to obtain each week two library books. The books were read by all the family; and in many homes the Sunday-school library furnished most of the reading matter. The literature may not have been of the highest grade, but, with all its defects, the Sunday-school library of the past was a useful and valuable institution.

2. **Its Decline in the Present.** In recent times, and especially in well-settled and cultured communities, the Sunday-school library has lost much of its importance. Very many schools have closed their libraries; and in the schools continuing their use only a small proportion of the scholars obtain books. Inquiry has shown that in cities and suburban towns a school of two hundred members will include not more than thirty who make use of the library. When the library is closed scarcely any complaints from the scholars are heard; nor is the closing of the library followed by a loss of scholars. Publishing houses which formerly issued fifty new books each year, especially for Sunday-school libraries, have entirely abandoned this branch of business. It cannot be maintained that the Sunday-school library for the entertainment of the scholars now holds a prominent place, or is a factor of success, in the best American Sunday schools.

3. Causes of Decline. It is not difficult to find reasons for this present lack of interest in the Sunday-school library. Books are now far more abundant than they were formerly. They are sold cheaply, and are to be found in almost every home. The periodical literature in circulation to-day is apparently a hundredfold greater than it was two generations ago. Every city and almost every town has its public library. Many schools are furnished with free libraries. Readers can scarcely find time for the books and magazines that are open to them. Moreover, the Sunday school now stands in such recognized honor and power that it no longer needs the old-time library as a bait for scholars. The library for mere recreation does not readily fit into the general scheme of education in the modern Sunday school. Then, too, the educational work of the school demands such an outfit of books and periodicals, renewed each year, that the additional expense of the library is a heavy burden. Sharp criticism is passed upon the quality of the books in most Sunday-school libraries, as being almost wholly stories, and stories of a cheap and commonplace character, many of them absolutely injurious. The conducting of the library is often found to interfere with the order and work of the school. These are among the causes which have led to disuse of the library in many Sunday schools.

4. The Uses of a Good Library. Notwithstanding the objections to the Sunday-school library, its neglect by many scholars, and its abolition in many schools, the fact remains that the majority of Sunday schools still retain the library, and claim that it is needed. There are even places where the Sunday-school library holds its own constituency in competition with the town library; and in small villages the Sunday school supplies most of the books in circulation. The principal claims made in behalf of such a library are the following:

(1) *Family Needs.* Every family needs good reading matter. The books that interest the young generally interest the old also. People who would be at a loss to select a book from the shelves of a public library will read the book brought to them from the Sunday-school library. The reading of the library-book fills leisure time on Sunday afternoons and on long winter evenings.

(2) *Moral Influence.* While most Sunday-school books as literature are open to criticism, yet in the realm of ethics they generally present high

ideals. The characters depicted in them may not be symmetrical, but on the whole they are earnest and upright. Youth admires heroism; and the personalities portrayed in popular Sunday-school books are generally heroic, even though they may be unduly emotional. The boys who are picked up by the police in railroad centers, armed for fighting Indians or robbing trains, generally carry an assortment of cheap novels, but they are not from Sunday-school libraries. If the criterion be ethics and not literature, most Sunday-school books will stand the test.

(3) *Aid to the School.* As has been already suggested, the original aim of the library was to attract scholars to the school. In many places this influence is no longer needed; but there still remain communities where scholars are obtained and families are interested by means of the library. And it is an open question whether if the library had advanced step by step with the other departments of the school, if the same attention had been given to the supply and management of the library as has been given to the educational work, if the right books had been kept upon its shelves, and advanced methods had been sought in their distribution, the library of the Sunday school might not still be a vigorous and successful institution.

5. Principles of Selection. If the governing board of the school decides that a library for general reading by the scholars is desirable, the question at once arises as to what principles shall determine the selection of books. A few of these principles may be stated:

(1) *Variety.* The library should represent more than one department of literature. So general is the taste for stories that the tendency will be inevitable to overload the library with works of fiction. Therefore special care should be given to include in it the lives of great and good men—heroes, statesmen, explorers, leaders of the church, and missionaries. All of these present life on its romantic side, and may be found written in an entertaining manner. Upon the shelves should also be placed history and science—not in many-volumed treatises for scholars, but in popular books for young people. In fact, there are few departments of a good public library which may not properly be included in the library of the Sunday school, especially in places where the school is expected to supply the reading matter for the community.

(2) *Popularity*. Merely to place books on the shelves of a Sunday-school library will not insure the reading of them. This library aims to be emphatically a circulating library. Its books are not for show, but for use; and their place to be seen is not on the shelves of the library-room, but in the homes of the scholars and teachers. It is absolutely essential that no book be placed in the library unless it is sufficiently interesting to be taken out and read, for an unread book is worse than useless in the Sunday-school library. Although its principles be as sound as the Ten Commandments, if it be dull it must be condemned. Students may be willing to plod through an uninteresting book because it is profitable, but ordinary readers, especially youthful readers, will turn from it. Books should not be purchased because they are good, or because they are cheap; nor, on the other hand, should they be chosen only because they are popular; yet an interesting, popular quality should be an absolute requirement in every book placed upon the library shelves.

(3) *Literary Quality*. Books are influential teachers, and a style like that of Hawthorne or Eliot will unconsciously mold the language of those who read it. On the other hand, the habitual readers of the slang in the comic paragraph of the newspaper will talk in a careless and inelegant manner. Of course, all books should be excluded from the library which deal in low, profane, or immoral language, without regarding the specious plea that such describe life as it is. We do not need to learn the language of the slums to know life; and, as one writer has said, we do not want a realism that can be touched only with a pair of tongs. The best pirate story in the English language is one that is without an oath from cover to cover,[\[10\]](#) and we would not exclude it from the Sunday-school library. Let us seek for writers whose expression is direct, smooth, and cultured. The Sunday school in its literature as well as its teaching should lead upward toward refinement of taste.

(4) *Moral Teaching*. The ethical standard of every book in the Sunday-school library should be of the highest. Not that every paragraph should end with the application like the *Hæc fabula docet* of Æsop's fables, or that the characters in a story should be of a "goody-goody" kind, or that none but good people should appear upon the page. There must be some shadows in the perspective that the light may stand in contrast. But in no case should wrong, or sin, or the doubtful moralities of modern society be made

attractive. Moral problem stories, in which the boundary lines of right and wrong conduct are crossed and re-crossed until right seems wrong, and wrong seems right, should have no place. "Should love stories be admitted?" Not if the element of love enters as the dominant thought of the book. A story should not be forbidden because there is a pair of lovers in it; but it should not be accepted if the book shows no higher motive than to set forth their passion. Books should be sought that will inculcate a noble manliness for young men and a noble womanliness for young women, and there are such books in numbers sufficient to fill the library shelves.

(5) *Christian Spirit*. It is not required that every book should set forth and illustrate a spiritual experience. It may be religious without preaching religion. But the morals it inculcates should be founded upon the gospels and inspired by faith. It should be reverent in its treatment of the Bible, of the church, and of the ministry. A book or a story designed to weaken belief in the Scriptures as records of the divine will, or holding the church up to scorn, or showing a minister as its villain, should be kept out of the Sunday-school library. Criticism or discussion of the Bible, of the church, and of the ministry has its place, but its place is not in the Sunday school. The Sunday school is distinctively a religious and a Christian institution, and the atmosphere of the Christian religion should pervade its library.

6. The Coming Sunday-School Library. Another library of a higher type than that designed for the reading and recreation of the scholars is now arising to notice in many advanced Sunday schools, and is destined to become the Sunday-school library of the future, either supplementing the library of the past or taking its place. It is the library which is to the Sunday school what the college library is to the college, a workshop equipped with tools for the use of the teacher and the scholar. It will be at once a reference library, containing the best Bible dictionaries, cyclopedias, expository works, and gospel harmonies, open at certain times for the use of students; and also a lending library of books upon the Bible, upon the Sunday school, upon teaching, upon religion, upon character, and upon the varied forms of social service which are now calling for workers, and will call yet more imperatively in the coming years. The books for this library must be chosen with wisdom; for they should represent the results of the best scholarship, yet be expressed in language that the nonprofessional reader can understand; and many of them must be for the scholars, who are of all ages

and all degrees of intelligence. Those of the Primary Department should be able to find in such a library the stories of the Bible told in such a fascinating manner that a child too young to read them may listen to them with interest, and picture-books illustrating the events, the people, the dress, and the landscape of the Bible. It should be planned to meet the needs of every grade in the Sunday school, and to aid every teacher and every scholar; and when established it should be made effective in the educational work of the school. Just as in the secular school and the college students are sent to the library with directions as to the books they will need, so in the Sunday school teachers will be able to counsel their scholars and to give them week-day work, so that the teaching will be more than the talk of the teacher; it will embrace the results of searching on the part of the scholar. Under the system of uniform lessons the use of such a library was well-nigh impracticable, because every class would need the same books at one time. But the uniform lessons are being rapidly displaced by the graded system, giving to each grade its own series of lessons; and this method, requiring different books for each age in the school, will open the way for reference work and study in the library. The time is at hand when such a working library will become a necessity in every well-organized school.

7. The Public Library and the Sunday School. It would seem that wherever the public library is free, available, and well conducted some arrangement might be effected whereby the Sunday-school libraries could be united with the public library. This would lessen expense and difficulty in management, would avoid the unnecessary reduplication of copies of the same books, and would give to the scholars at once a wider selection and the advantage of the open shelf. In more than one town this has been accomplished. The Sunday schools have transferred all their libraries to the public library, to its enlargement, and with no loss of members to the schools. Some Sunday schools in cities have been recognized as branch stations of the public library, giving them the benefit of frequent changes in the equipment of books, which at regular intervals are selected from the store of the public library by the library committee of the school. The working library for teachers and scholars, proposed in the last paragraph, in many places might be established in the public library, wherever the schools in the community will unite to show that it is needed, to name the books required, and to make it practically useful.

XII

THE MANAGEMENT OF THE LIBRARY

1. **Library Committee.** For the selection of books, whether in the reading library for scholars or the working library for teachers and scholars, a wise, intelligent, and careful committee should be chosen, and should be maintained in permanent service. The pastor and the superintendent should be ex-officio members of this committee, but it should also include some other persons sufficiently acquainted with books to pass upon their merits, and willing to give time, inquiry, and thought to the library. There may be schools fortunate in possessing librarians who devote themselves to the selection of books, as well as to the care of them; and in such schools the library committees will find their labors lessened. No book should be admitted to the library without examination and approval by the committee.

(1) *Purchase of Books.* The simplest method for finding books is far from being the best method. It is to have a quantity of books—a hundred or more at one time—sent by booksellers on approval. This method involves hasty examination, and generally results in obtaining many useless, worthless books intermixed with a few good ones. The better plan is for the committee, first of all, to be supplied with catalogues from reputable publishers of books for children and young people, and also books on religious and biblical education; next to read carefully the reviews of books in these departments as given in the best literary and religious periodicals; then, to send only for such books as they judge will be desirable, receiving them on approval. Every book should not only be looked at, but read; and if at all doubtful read by more than one member of the committee. In some Sunday schools there is placed at the door a library box, in which may be deposited the names of books desired by members of the school. Lists of approved books are published by various houses and societies; and the catalogues of a few good Sunday-school libraries will aid committees. The library committee must scrutinize closely all donations of books offered to the library, and resolutely decline every book that is unsuitable, even at the

risk of offending the donor. The Sunday-school library room must not be turned into a mausoleum for dead volumes. The committee must also beware of bargains offered by some booksellers who would unload upon Sunday schools their left-over and unsalable stock. That which costs little is generally worth less. The Sunday school must obtain only books that will be read and are worth reading.

(2) *Frequent Additions*. The usual method is to use the old library until its best books are either worn out or lost, and then to make a strenuous effort at raising money for the purchase of an entirely new collection. But the better plan is to add a few carefully selected books each month to the library. To examine at one time two hundred volumes is an impossibility, and in so large a purchase many undesirable books are sure to be included. It is not difficult to select after careful examination ten books each month, and thereby keep the library always at a high grade of excellence. With each purchase a slip describing the new books might be printed, and distributed to the school, thus keeping the library constantly before its patrons.

2. **The Librarian.** There is a close analogy between the work of the librarian in the public library and that in the Sunday school. For the public library everywhere a specialist is sought, one who knows books, can select them wisely, and can aid seekers after literature in their reading. The Sunday school needs just such a librarian, and all the more because the scholars cannot select from the open shelf, but must guess at the quality of a book from its title in the catalogue. It has been noticed that wherever a Sunday-school library is successful in holding the interest of the scholars there is found with it a librarian adapted to his work and devoting himself to it. We notice the characteristics of a good librarian in the Sunday school:

(1) *A Bookman*. He is a lover of books, acquainted with them, and interested in good literature. His work is more than to distribute books: he should aid, sometimes supervise, their collection.

(2) *A Business Man*. He is practical, orderly, and systematic in his ways of working; with a plan for his task, and fidelity in accomplishing it.

(3) *Gentle in Manner*. Opportunities will be frequent for the librarian to clash with the scholars on the one hand, or with the superintendent upon the other. With one he may appear arbitrary, with the other disorderly, his work

sometimes breaking into the program of exercises. He should be pleasant toward all, uniform in his dealings, and attentive to the general order of the school.

3. **His Assistants.** In most schools one assistant, in large schools several assistants, will be required by the librarian. He should nominate them, subject to the approval of the governing board of the school; and should require of them regular and prompt attendance, and attention to their work in the library. It is very desirable that the business should be so arranged as to allow the librarians to take part in the opening devotional service with the school, and not to be at work arranging books while others are at prayer.

4. **The Management of the Library.** This involves four processes: the collection, the assignment, the distribution, and the return of the books.

(1) *The Collection.* The books can easily be collected without interfering with the order of the school, if the library window is near the entrance to the building, and the scholars as they enter leave their books at the library. This is the method employed in most schools.

(2) *The Assignment.* How to enable each scholar to choose his book introduces one of the three problems in library management. The plan generally followed is to supply each scholar with a card bearing a number which represents the scholar. He selects from the catalogue a large assortment of books, and writes their numbers upon his card: the librarian assigns the scholar any one of the books selected, crosses it from his list, and upon another list marks the number of the book opposite the number of the scholar. The weakness of the plan is in the fact that the scholar has no means of learning from the catalogue what books are desirable; and a book desired by one may be entirely undesirable to another. Theoretically the scholar has the whole catalogue from which to choose; practically he has no choice, except the suggestion in the titles of the books. The open-shelf plan cannot be established in the Sunday school, for the room is usually too small, the time of the session is too brief, and the work of the school too important to allow interruption.

In some graded Sunday schools another plan is pursued, taking from the scholar all choice, but assigning to each grade books of certain numbers, all printed upon the card of the scholar, any one of which books he may receive

at any time during his stay in the grade, but each of which will fall to his lot but once. This plan demands a library of books carefully selected, and as carefully fitted to each grade in the school. But this method is apt to be unsatisfactory to the scholars, who have their own preferences among the books. The difficulties in assigning books, and disappointments of scholars in failing to obtain the books desired, is a frequent cause for the disuse of the library; and this problem has not as yet been fully solved.

(3) *The Distribution.* This takes place at the close of the school, and brings in the second problem of library management. The books may be brought to the classes by the librarians, and distributed by the teachers; each scholar's book being indicated by his card placed within it. This method often causes confusion; scholars being dissatisfied with their books and leaving their classes press around the library. Sometimes they exchange books with each other. This is a simple plan as far as the two scholars exchanging are concerned, but sure to make trouble in the record of the librarian. Or each class may be dismissed in turn, and obtain its books at the library window while passing out. But this plan causes a congestion of scholars at the library, and also requires much time. To manage the distribution of books demands a strong will, coupled with a gentle manner in maintaining the library rules.

(4) *The Return.* The theory of the Sunday-school library is that each scholar will bring his book back after a week or two weeks. But boys and girls—sometimes older scholars also—are apt to be careless. Books are exchanged between scholars, are loaned from one home to another, are forgotten, and are lost. And the books lost most readily are frequently those that are most sought for by the scholars. How to induce scholars invariably to return their books constitutes the third problem of library management. In many schools the percentage of lost books is exceedingly large. The librarian should do his utmost to reduce the loss to a minimum. To this end a few suggestions may be given:

(a) *Record of Scholars.* Every scholar's name and address, with his library number, should be kept on record in the library; and every effort should be made to make the record conform to all changes in residence.

(b) Record Sheet. The library should contain a record sheet, showing the number of every book issued, and the number of the scholar receiving it; to be canceled when the book is returned. This will show who is responsible for every book out of its place from the library.

(c) Fines. A fine should be assessed upon the scholar for every book kept over time; and notice sent to the scholar at his home when a fine has become due.

(d) Rewards. Scholars should be paid a reward, perhaps of ten cents for each book, if they can succeed in tracing and finding any book which has been out of the library two months or more. These plans, or others, may lessen, but no plan will entirely remove, the evil of books lost to the library through neglect or a worse crime.

THE TEACHER'S QUALIFICATIONS AND NEED OF TRAINING

While the superintendent in the school is the moving and guiding intelligence, the pulse of the machine, the teacher in the class is the worker at the anvil, or the loom, or the lathe, for whom all the plans are made, and upon whom all the success depends. In the warfare for souls he is on the picket line and at close range, fighting face to face and hand to hand. The sphere of his effort is small, that group gathered around him for an hour on Sunday, but in that little field his is the work that counts for the final victory. His task requires peculiar adaptedness, supplemented by special training.

1. His Qualifications. There are on the American continent not less than a million and a half Sunday-school teachers, who give to the gospel their free-will offering of time, and toil, and thought. They are not like civil engineers or the majority of public-school teachers, graduates of schools that have given them training for a special vocation. In every respect they are laymen, engaged for six days in secular work, and on one day finding an avocation in the Sunday school. Yet there are certain traits, partly natural and partly acquired, which they must possess, if they are to find success in their Sabbath-day service.

(1) *A Sincere Disciple.* The Sunday-school teacher must be a follower of Christ, not merely in profession but in spirit. He is one who has met his Lord, has heard and has obeyed the call, "Follow me." He enlisted in the grand army of which Christ is the Commander, before he received his assignment to the army corps of the Sunday school, and his fidelity to the department is inspired by his deeper loyalty to his Lord. It is eminently desirable that the Sunday-school teacher should be a member of the church; but it is imperative that he should be a disciple of Christ.

(2) *A Lover of Youth.* By far the largest proportion of scholars in the Sunday school, perhaps nine tenths, are under twenty-five years of age. Therefore, with few exceptions, the teachers must deal with young people; and youth at all its stages is not easy to understand and to manage. Moreover, the fact that not only the teachers, but to a large extent the

scholars, are volunteers enters into the problem. Pupils attend the week-day school and submit to a teacher's rule because they must, whether their teachers are acceptable or are disliked. But the rule in the Sunday school is not the law of authority; it is the law of persuasion. The teacher who cannot draw his scholars, but repels them, soon finds himself without a class. In all teaching sympathy, or the coördination between the interest of the teacher in the pupil and of the pupil in the teacher, is a strong factor in success; but in the Sunday school it is an absolute necessity by reason of the voluntary element in the constitution of the Sunday school. That mystic power which will combine uncongenial spirits, and fuse the hearts of teacher and scholar into one, is love. Let the teacher love his scholars, let him see in each pupil some quality to inspire love, and the battle is half won. Love will quicken tact, and love and tact together will win the complete victory.

(3) *A Lover of the Scriptures.* Whatever the Sunday school of to-morrow may become, the Sunday school of to-day is preëminently a Bible school. There are tendencies in our time which may in another generation render the Bible less prominent, and introduce into the Sunday school studies in church history, in social science, in moral reform, in missions, perhaps in comparative religion, or in some other departments of knowledge. But as yet the great text-book of the school is the Holy Scriptures. The volume should be in the hand of every teacher and of every scholar during the school session; and the teacher, especially, must study it during the week. If all of the Bible that he knows is contained in the paragraphs assigned for the coming lesson, and the rest of the book is sealed to his eyes, he will be a very poor teacher. He needs to have his mind stored with a thousand facts, and to have these facts systematized, in order to teach ten; and the nine hundred and ninety which he knows will add all their weight to the ten which he tells.

(4) *A Willing Worker.* The teacher's love for Christ, for his scholars, and for his Bible is not to expend itself in emotion or even in study; it is to find expression in efficient service. A task is laid upon him which will demand much of his time and his power of body, mind, and spirit. He must be ready to meet his class fifty-two Sundays in the year: on days of sunshine and days of storm; when he is eager for the work, and when he is weary in it; when his scholars are responsive, and when they are careless; when his fellow workers are congenial, and when they are anti-pathetic; when his

lesson is easy to teach, and when it is hard. He must be regular in his service, not turned aside by opportunities of enjoyment elsewhere; and he must give to it all his powers and all his skill. Work such as this can be sustained only by an enduring enthusiasm, a devotion to the cause; and therefore the teacher must have his heart enlisted as well as his will.

As a Sunday-school teacher, then, four harmonious objects will claim a share in his love: his Lord, his scholars, his Bible, and his work.

2. His Need of Training. For two generations it was supposed that any person fairly intelligent, without special equipment, was fitted to be a Sunday-school teacher. There are found no records of training classes in Sunday-school work earlier than 1855, when the Rev. John H. Vincent began to gather young people and train them for service in his Sunday school at Irvington, New Jersey. The seed of his "Palestine Class" grew into the "Normal Class"; and by 1869 there were in a few places classes for the teaching of teachers in the Bible and Sunday-school work. It is not remarkable that Sunday-school teacher-training should be delayed so long after the organization of the first Sunday school, when it is remembered that in America the first Normal School for secular teachers was not founded until 1839. The Chautauqua movement, begun in 1874, gave a strong impetus to Sunday-school teacher-training; the state associations and denominational organizations took up the work; and now teacher-training classes are to be found in every state and province on the American continent. The thoroughly graded school includes in its system a class for the training of young people who are to be teachers.

It is late in the day to inquire why the Sunday-school teacher needs training; but the question is often asked, and the answers are ready:

(1) *The General Principle.* All good work involves the prerequisite of training. Especially is this true of teaching; and there is a reason why the principle holds with regard to the Sunday-school teacher even more directly than with the secular teacher. While the subjects of teaching are vitally important, relating to character and efficient service, the time for teaching is short, less than an hour each week, in contrast to the twenty or twenty-five hours in the week-day school. To make an impression in so short a teaching period, with such long intervals between the lessons, demands that the

teacher be one who possesses exceptional fitness for his work, and this superior fitness cannot be obtained without special and thorough training.

(2) *The Teacher's Responsibility.* All-important as is the work of religious teaching, for which the Bible is the chief text-book in the church, there is but one institution in our time charged with that mighty duty, and that is the Sunday school. The Bible is rarely taught in the home, which should be the first place for teaching it; it is only incidentally taught in the pulpit, of which the aim is not so much instruction as inspiration. Practically all the teaching of the Bible now devolves upon the Sunday school, and the Sunday school only. If the Sunday schools of the world for one generation should fail to teach the word of life, the knowledge of that word would well-nigh cease. And the one person charged with that task, the one on whom the responsibility rests, is the Sunday-school teacher. He who is intrusted with so great a work, and upon whose fidelity the work depends, must have a proper equipment; and that equipment presupposes training.

(3) *The Demand of the Age.* We are living in an intellectual age, unparalleled in the history of the world. The boundaries of knowledge in every direction have widened, and in each realm the search is deeper and more thorough. Such wealth has been added through recent investigations to the store of Bible knowledge that most commentaries, expositions, and introductions of the past have now but slight value. Another exceedingly important realm that has been added to the domain of knowledge is that of child study, but recently an unexplored field, now open to every reader. In such a time as this the teacher who would impart the contents of the Bible to the young must have eyes and mind opened. He must know the results of modern investigation in the Scriptures and in the nature of those whom he teaches. His pupils are under the care of trained and alert specialists through the week; they must receive instruction from well-taught minds in the Sunday school.

(4) *The Teacher and His Class.* The peculiar relation already referred to as existing between the Sunday-school teacher and his class presents another incentive to training. His relation is not like that of the secular teacher, who speaks with authority, and can command attention and study. The teacher in Sunday school cannot require his scholars to learn the lesson; the authority of the parent is rarely employed to compel home study;

and as a result most of our scholars come to the Sunday school unprepared. This is not the ideal or the ultimate condition, but unfortunately it is still the real condition in at least nine out of ten Sunday-school classes. This condition makes the demand upon the teacher all the greater. Because his scholars are unprepared he must be all the better prepared. He must be able to awaken and arouse his pupils; he must inspire them to an interest in the lesson; he must so teach as to lead them into knowledge of the truth and a desire to seek it for themselves. Anyone can teach the scholar who is eager to learn; but to teach those who come to the class unprepared and careless, to send them away with a clear-cut understanding of the lesson, and an awakened intelligence and conscience—all this, under the conditions of the Sunday-school teacher's task, and in his peculiar relation to his scholars, requires not only ability, but also thoroughly trained ability.

In view of all these considerations, it is not surprising that at the opening of the twentieth century the demand of the Sunday schools everywhere is for better teaching, and for teachers who have themselves been taught and are able to teach others.

XIV

THE TRAINING AND TASK OF THE TEACHER

1. **The Training Needed.** Many faithful workers in the Sunday school realize their need of preparation; but, while conscious of unfitness, they have no clear conception of the equipment which they require. What are those fields of knowledge which should be traversed by one who has been called to teach in the Sunday school? They comprise four departments: (1) the Book, (2) the scholar, (3) the school, and (4) the work.

(1) *The Book.* We have already noted that the Sunday school is differentiated from other systems of education in the fact that it uses mainly but one text-book, the Holy Scriptures. For that reason the teacher must first of all acquaint himself as thoroughly as possible with the contents of that wonderful volume. He should be a twentieth century Bible student; not a student or a scholar according to the light of the Middle Ages, or the seventeenth century, or even of the first half of the nineteenth century; for in all those periods the aims, the methods, and the scope of Bible study were different from those of the present time. He who is to teach the Bible successfully to-day must have some knowledge of the Bible in the following aspects:

(a) *Its Origin and Nature.* He must have a definite idea of how the sixty-six books of Scripture were composed, written, and preserved; and, as far as may be known, who were their authors.

(b) *Its History.* The Bible is, more than anything else, a book of history, containing the record of a people who received the divine revelation and preserved it. The divine revelation cannot be taught nor comprehended unless the annals of that remarkable people, the Israelites, be first read and understood. Therefore biblical history should be the first subject to be studied by the teacher in the Sunday school. The leading facts and underlying principles of that unique history must be understood; not in an

outline of minute details, but as a general landscape, in which each lesson of the Bible will take its place.

(c) Its Geographical Background. The Bible brings before us a world of natural features which remain—seas, mountains, valleys, and plains; a world of political divisions which has passed away; its empires, kingdoms, and tribal relations; and cities and towns, some of them now desolate, others in poverty and in ruin. The teacher who is to instruct his pupils must be able to see those abiding elements, and by the aid of his historical imagination to reconstruct those that have changed. He must make that ancient world of the Bible roll like a panorama before the eyes of his mind.

(d) Its Institutions. Upon every page of the Bible are stamped pictures of manners, customs, institutions, forms of worship, that are unfamiliar to our Christian, Anglo-Saxon, modern world. The teacher must become familiar with this local color of another civilization, and enable his class to see it through his eyes.

(e) Its Ethical and Religious Teaching. In the past, and until a generation ago, the Bible was studied only for its doctrines. It was generally treated as one book, all written at once and by one author; its history, biography, institutions, were passed over as unimportant; while every sentence was searched for some light upon theology. From the Bible, by assorting and grouping its texts out of every book, a system of doctrine was constructed; and the mastery of this system with its proof-texts was regarded as the principal work of the Bible student. That method of Bible study has justly fallen into disuse among modern scholars. The Bible is now looked upon as a record of life rather than as a treasury of texts. Yet its stream of ethical, religious, and spiritual teaching must be found and followed by the student who is to teach the truth; and the doctrines revealed through the Bible should be regarded as a necessary part of his training.

(2) *The Scholar.* One book must be studied closely by the teacher, and that is his pupils. During the last thirty years human nature in all its stages, as child, as youth, during adolescence, and in maturity—especially in the earlier periods—has been investigated as never before. The student in our time can enter into the results of special study upon these subjects. He needs to know what the best books can give him of child study and mind

study; and to supplement book-knowledge in this department with watchful eyes and close thought upon the traits which he finds in his own scholars.

(3) *The School*. The teacher in the Sunday school needs to understand the institution wherein he is a worker. The Sunday school is like the week-day school, yet unlike it; and the teacher must be able to appreciate at once what he can follow and what he should avoid in the methods of the secular school. The history of the Sunday-school movement, its fundamental principles, its organization, officers, methods of management, and aims—all these are in the scope of the teacher's preparation.

(4) *The Work*. Whether on Sunday or on Monday, a teacher is after all a teacher, and the laws of true teaching are the same in a Sunday school, in a public school, and in a college. The application of those laws may vary according to the ages of pupils, the subjects of instruction, and the aims of the institution, but the principles are unchanging. Those enduring principles of instruction are well understood, are set down in text-books, and can easily be learned by a student. There are successful teachers who know these principles by an intuition that they cannot explain; but most people will save themselves from many mistakes and comparative failure by a close study of modern educational methods.

In some way knowledge in all these four great departments of training should be obtained by the teacher, if possible, before he enters upon his task; but if he has missed earlier opportunities of preparation he must acquire this knowledge even while he is teaching. The outlines of such a course of study should be given in the training class for young people; and such a training class should be regarded as essential to every well-organized school.[\[11\]](#)

2. The Teacher's Task. All the preparation briefly outlined in these last paragraphs is only preparatory to the work which the teacher is to do in his vocation. The task set before the teacher is fourfold:

(1) *As a Student*. The studies named above are not completed when the teacher has passed out of the training class with a certificate of graduation. The public-school teacher who ceases to study after finishing the course of the normal school is foredoomed to failure. The training class or the training school has only outlined before the teacher the fields to be

traversed, and shown him a few paths which he may follow. He who has undertaken to teach a group of scholars, whether in the Beginners Department, the Senior Department, or any grade between them, must continue his studies, in the Bible, in the specific course of graded lessons which he is teaching, and in general knowledge; for there is no department of thought or action which will not bring tribute to the teacher, to be turned into treasure for his class. The Sunday-school teacher must ever maintain an open mind, a quick eye, and a spirit eager for knowledge. His accumulation will prove a store upon which to draw for teaching; and even that unused will give its weight to truth imparted to his class.

(2) *As a Friend.* The teacher is more than a student dealing with books; he is a living soul in contact with living souls. If the most masterly lesson teaching in the realm of thought could be spoken into a phonograph, and then ground out before a class, it would fail to teach, for it would utterly lack the human element. Knowledge counts for much in teaching, but personality counts for far more. If a teacher is to be successful he must have a close relationship with his class. They must know him, he must know them, and there must be a common interest, nay, a common affection, between the two personalities of teacher and pupil. He must be a friend to each one of his scholars, schooling himself, if need be, to friendship; and each of his scholars must be made to realize that his teacher is his friend. This personal affection need not always be stated in words. The teacher who constantly assures his scholars that he loves them will not be believed as readily as the one who shows his love in his spirit and his acts, even though he may refrain from affectionate forms of speech.

(3) *As a Teacher.* Teaching requires more than the possession of an abundant store of information upon any subject. He is not a teacher who simply pours forth upon the ears of his pupils an undigested mass of facts, however valuable those facts may be. The true teacher after large preparation assorts his material, and selects such matter as is appropriate to his own class. This he arranges in a form to be readily received, thoroughly comprehended, and easily remembered. He comes before his class with the fixed purpose that every pupil shall carry away with him a knowledge of the lesson, and shall not forget it. He must awaken the pupil's attention; for talking to an inattentive group of people accomplishes no more than preaching to tombstones in a graveyard. He must obtain the coöperation of

the pupil's interest, and induce him to think upon the subject. He must call forth from his pupil some expression of his thought in language, for one is never sure of his knowledge until he has shaped it into words; and that which the pupil has stated he is much surer to remember than that which he has merely heard. Teaching, then, involves (1) selection of material, (2) adaptation of material, (3) presentation of truth, (4) awakening thought, (5) calling forth expression, (6) fixing knowledge in the memory.

(4) *As a Disciple.* It is the teacher's task not only to impart to his scholars valuable information about the Bible, about God, about Christ, and about salvation; but, far more than imparting an intellectual knowledge, to bring the living word into relation with living souls, to inspire a fellowship of his pupils with God, to have Christ founded within them, to make salvation through Christ their joyous possession. Nor is his work as a working disciple accomplished when all his scholars have become Christians in possession and profession, and members of Christ's Church. By his example and his teachings he should lead them to efficient service for Christ in the church, in the community, and in the state. There is work for every member in the church, and work for everyone possessing the spirit of Christ in the community. Whatever may have been the type of a saint in the twelfth century, or in the sixteenth, or even in the early nineteenth century, in these stirring, strenuous years of the twentieth century the disciple of Christ is a man among men or a woman among women, active in the effort to make the world better, and to establish in his own village, or town, or ward of the city, the kingdom of heaven on earth. To inspire his scholars for such labors, and to lead them, is the supreme opportunity and work of the teacher.

XV

THE CONSTITUENCY OF THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

1. Relation to the Community. The Sunday school is a temple built of living stones; and the quarry from which they are taken in the rough, to be cut and polished for their places in the building, is the entire community in which the school is placed. In our time, more than ever before, the reasons are imperative why special study should be given to the community from which the school must draw its members. Certain principles of administration will become apparent when once the field is carefully considered.

(1) *Constituency Adjacent.* The population from which a given Sunday school draws its members must be generally that immediately around it. Some teachers and scholars may come from a distance, but even in this age of convenient transit by trains and trolley cars, it is found that, taking the church building as a center, the constituency of the Sunday school in a city is mostly within a radius of half a mile, and in the country within a mile. Throughout that sphere of influence the church should look well to the population, should know its proportionate elements, as far as possible should come into acquaintance with the families, and should plan to win, to evangelize, and to hold all its natural following.

(2) *Membership Representative.* Upon general and almost invariable principles, the Sunday school should represent all the elements of the population within its environment. If it be a residence section with isolated houses, each containing but one family of well-to-do people, the church is apt to be a family church, and a large Sunday school must not be looked for, since large mansions rarely contain large families. If, on the other hand, the neighborhood be populous, characterized by varied strata of society—a few rich, a goodly number fairly prosperous, and a greater mass of wage-earners, yet the section as a whole American and not foreign in its civilization—then a flourishing, active, and growing Sunday school should

be expected. And it should embrace all these elements, the rich, the middle class, and the wage-earners, in the proportion which each bears to the community as a whole. If the school in such a population be small, or if it be composed exclusively of one class, whether it be the so-called better class or the mission class, there is a serious error in its policy. The true Sunday school should be representative of all the elements in the population. It is both a crime and a blunder to limit the efforts of a Sunday school to one class of society: a crime, because such a school leaves multitudes around it to perish; and a blunder, because the effort results in an anæmic, dwindling, dying institution.

(3) *Methods Adapted.* Almost every community, whether in city or in country, possesses some traits peculiar to itself. There may be two towns ten miles apart, one the wealthy residential suburb of a city, the other a settlement surrounding a great factory. The population of these two places will be in marked contrast, and the methods of Christian work successful in one will utterly fail in the other. One street or avenue in a city may mark the boundary line between family churches and mission churches. Within ten minutes' walk of each other may stand two churches of the same denomination, yet so utterly apart in spirit as to possess nothing in common but name. It is possible that each of these two organizations might learn something from the other, and might do their Master's work better by a closer community of interest and feeling. Yet it would be a mistake to introduce into either church all the plans that are successful in the other; or to reject in one Sunday school any method because it has proved a failure in another and a different field. The work of each church and Sunday school must be adapted to the population from which its membership is to be drawn.

2. The Changing Population. One of the most imperative questions confronting the gospel worker, both in the church and the Sunday school, arises from the constant changes taking place in our population. In the cities we see stately churches, once thronged, now well-nigh desolate, while their walls echo to the tread upon the sidewalk of a churchless multitude. In front of a fine old church, where once millionaires worshiped, the writer has often passed a news-stand upon which are for sale newspapers in seven different languages. And too often one finds that the churches of a generation ago have been turned into low theaters, or torn down, giving

place to stores and office buildings. The general principle may be laid down, that a church in the city almost never lives more than one generation in the same building and with the same character. After thirty years as the very longest period, if it is to retain its members, it must follow them in the march up-town; or if it is to retain its location and still hold a congregation it must seek an absolutely new constituency, and to this end must transform its methods of work. Nor are these migrations of population confined to the city. The towns and villages are governed by the same law of change. A village, once the seat of quiet homes, is suddenly turned into a factory town, with a new and strange population. The farms on country roads, abandoned by the families that formerly tilled them, are occupied by foreigners of alien speech and manners. The building of a railroad will open new towns, and at the same time will make more than one deserted village. These changes in population must be considered in their relation to the work of the Sunday school. The movement will be characterized by varied traits in different places.

(1) *A Growing Population.* The change may be that of a healthy growth in population, making the community a desirable place for a church and a Sunday school. Such a development is constantly taking place in the newer portions of a city, whose population is moving from the center to the rim; or it may be noted in suburban towns, as facilities of transportation bring new residents from the metropolis; or it may appear in villages springing up on the line of a railroad, where home-seekers are settling and building habitations. Leaders in church and Sunday-school work must watch these growing centers, and provide wisely for their religious needs. It will not suffice to wait for these newcomers to build their own churches and organize their own Sunday schools. Most of them are taxed to the utmost in building or buying their own homes, and will scarcely realize their need until the habit of neglecting worship has become fixed, and their children grow up without religious education. The old and strong churches must extend a hand to the settlers, must preëempt church sites at the very beginning, must help to erect chapels, for a time must supply workers, and must set the current of the new settlement Godward and churchward. The reward of their labor and their liberality will not long be delayed.

(2) *A Declining Population.* There are places where the population has lessened, making the work of the Sunday school increasingly difficult and

its results meager. It may be in the city, where business has crowded away the dwellers of other years, as in the lower end of Manhattan Island in New York. There tall office buildings and warehouses stand on sites formerly occupied by churches, but no longer needed, now that almost the only residents are the janitors and their families, living on the roofs of the towerlike temples of trade. But oftener the region of the declining population is found in the country. Villages once prosperous have gradually lost their inhabitants. In places where three or four churches, each with its Sunday school, were formerly well supported, there is now scarcely a constituency for one. Yet all these churches, though decayed and dying by inches, are still maintained; and each church still houses a discouraged Sunday school, attended by a faithful few, but with no hope of growth and an imminent peril of extinction. If loyalty to a denomination could give way to love for the kingdom of Christ, these might be consolidated into one church and one Sunday school for all the community. We venture the prophecy that before the twentieth century comes to its close this will be throughout the American continent the accepted settlement of the question. May its fulfillment be not long delayed! In the meantime these decayed but still enduring Sunday schools and churches in a community should seek for peace and friendship, not emphasizing the points of doctrine or of system that differ, but those that agree, and striving to maintain the unity of the spirit in a bond of love.

(3) *A Population Changing Socially.* A serious problem often arises, not from a decline but from a change in the social condition of the population within the sphere of the church. The downtown church may have been forsaken by its former members, but people of another class, and in greater numbers, have taken their places. The mansions have become boarding houses, flats and apartment houses have arisen, while the thronged sidewalks, and the children playing in the streets, are evidence that the material for members of the church and the Sunday school is greater than before. True, the new inhabitants are of a different social order from the old, clerks and porters instead of merchants, employees instead of employers, working people in place of the leisure class. The fact that the social level of the neighborhood may be regarded by the worldly-minded as lower than formerly does not lessen its need of the gospel, nor render it less promising for Christian work. The church should look upon its field with unprejudiced

eyes, should have an understanding of the time; should be alert to see and to seize its opportunity; and should change its methods with its changed constituency. The field must not be abandoned; it must be cultivated, and new forms of tillage will bring forth abundant harvests.

(4) *An Alien Population.* The most perplexing of all social problems arises when immigration has swept into the district surrounding the church a tide of people whose birth and speech are foreign, supplanting and in large measure driving out the native population. There are sections in our cities where the signs on the stores are all Bohemian, or Polish, or Yiddish; where an English-speaking church would remain absolutely empty, though thousands throng the streets. It may be that in such conditions gospel work under American methods can no longer be maintained; and a removal may be necessary. But even in the most unpromising fields this conclusion should not be hastily reached. We spend large sums in sending missionaries to the lands from which some strangers come; should we not embrace opportunities of evangelizing these at our own door? There are difficulties, but they are not nearly as insuperable as those in foreign fields. These foreign-born or foreign-descended children sit beside our own in the public school; should we shut them out from our Sunday schools? In less than a generation millions of these boys and girls will be as thoroughly American as our own children. When we consider the question of abandoning any field on account of its foreign population, let us widen our horizon of thought to embrace the future as well as the present, and then form our conclusion concerning the duty of the Sunday school to the community.

3. Practical Suggestions. A few hints, some of them already given, may summarize the practical side of the subject:

(1) *Study the Field.* The Sunday school must live not in the past, but in the present, with a clear vision of the future. It must not only cherish a loving memory of its field as it has been, but understand thoroughly what it is, and what forces are shaping it for the future. The leaders in each Sunday school working for itself, or preferably those conducting the Sunday schools of a neighborhood working unitedly, should ascertain the nationality, religious condition, and church relations of every family in the district; and not only of every family, of every individual who may have a room in a boarding house. Each political organization knows the residence

and party proclivities of every voter in the district; and the churches may learn from the politicians practical lessons upon the best methods of work.

(2) *Cultivate the Field.* Since the scholars must come to the school from the population around it, they should be sought, brought in, taught, and evangelized, with all the energy and wisdom which the church possesses. And not only the scholars, but also, in large degree, the teachers must be home-born and home-taught; therefore the Sunday school, to be successful, must train up workers from its own constituency.

(3) *Provide for all Elements.* By diligent and constant effort the school should be made representative of all ages, of all classes, of all sections, and as far as practicable of all races found in its community.

(4) *Adapt Methods.* If a former constituency has removed from the field, and a new population has surged in, the new element must be looked upon as the constituency of the school. Its needs must be recognized, however different they may be from the needs of the past; and plans must be formed to meet those needs, whatever transformation of the school the new plans may involve.

XVI

RECRUITING THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

1. **Necessity.** The aspiration for advancement is natural and noble; and therefore every member of the Sunday school who is interested in its welfare, whether officer, teacher, or pupil, desires it to increase in membership, and to spread its benefits as widely as possible. But the recruiting of the Sunday school is not only desirable, but necessary. It is found that in every school there exists an outflow as well as an inflow of members. If in certain departments, as the Primary, new scholars are constantly enrolled, in other departments, as the older grades of the Intermediate and the Senior, there is as constant a dropping out of members from the school. It has been estimated that in most Sunday schools from twenty to twenty-five per cent of the membership changes annually, so that the average period of a teacher or scholar in the Sunday school is less than five years. There are some who remain longer, but others who are members for even a shorter time. Upon the average, every school is a new school once in four or five years. If one fifth of the school leaves every year, there must be an equal number enter it, to keep the school at its normal size. But any institution dependent upon the maintenance of a constituency, whether it be a periodical, a life-insurance association, or a Sunday school, begins to decline when its number remains stationary. The health and life of the school, therefore, require a constant renewal of its membership. The school must have new blood, or it will soon be impoverished and in time die.

2. **The Losses from the School.** Before the presentation of plans for winning new scholars comes the vital question of holding the scholars already on the roll; for the condition of leakage has a close relation to growth or decline. If the causes of the leakage can be ascertained, and the drain can be stopped, we shall be materially aided in our effort to enlarge the school.

(1) *The Search in the School.* Careful notation should be kept of the grades from which scholars are lost, or which are below a normal membership; and equally careful inquiry should be made as to the cause of the decline, and methods to correct it should be sought. Is it in the Primary Department, which should be the most rapidly growing department in the school? Is it in the Junior or Intermediate Department, where there ought to be a steady increase, even if it be slow? Is it in the Senior Department? Here there is great danger of losses, especially among young men. Is it not possible to find why they leave the school, and what will induce them to remain? Perhaps the school is deficient in the Adult Department. Must it be admitted that the Sunday school is for children only, and that as soon as its members become men and women their departure from the school is to be expected? The investigation should be more than general, ascertaining what departments are suffering loss; it should be personal, including the name and grade of every scholar who has ceased to attend for a definite period; and as far as possible the reason for his leaving the school.

(2) *Following up Absentees.* A systematic plan for watching over the membership of the school should be instituted and vigorously maintained. For example, in some schools a report of every absentee is made by the secretary to the superintendent. On Monday morning each teacher receives by mail the list of his absent scholars, with a request to send in writing, as soon as practicable, the cause of absence for each one. In many schools this work of looking after the absentees is performed by paid visitors—a good plan, but not so good as for the teacher to come into personal touch with his own scholars. A business firm watches over its customers, and endeavors in every possible way to hold them. The Sunday school which can maintain its grasp upon its members has the problem of growth already half solved.

3. Characteristics of a Growing School. The strongest force in recruiting the Sunday school is to be found in the character of the school itself. The merchant must have his shelves stocked with attractive goods if he expects customers. In order to obtain scholars there must be a good school.

(1) *Efficient.* The school should maintain high educational standards; should be thoroughly graded in all its departments, with suitable lessons for

each grade; and should have organized classes for young people and adults. The thoroughly good school will rarely lack for scholars.

(2) *Attractive.* The school should be attractive as well as efficient. Its meeting place should be cheerful and airy, with suitable furniture and apparatus, above ground, and not a damp, dingy basement. It should have enjoyable exercises, like a school, yet not too severely like a public school. It should greet new members heartily, make them feel at home, and cultivate acquaintance with them. There should be an animating spirit of loyalty and love for the school; a devotion which will inspire active effort in its behalf. Around the school should be the atmosphere of a happy home.

(3) *Prominent.* Among the activities of the church the school should stand forth prominently. It should be kept in mind that, as the neighborhood furnishes the constituency of the school, so the school furnishes the members for the church. In our time three fourths of the accessions by profession of faith come from the Sunday school. The school should be held in honor as the principal source of supply to the church membership. If the audience room is large and imposing, and the Sunday-school room is inferior and unattractive; if the pulpit and the choir are amply supported while the school receives a narrow sustenance, however great the prosperity of the church its duration will be brief. The Sunday school must stand in the foreground, and not in the background, if the church is to grow; and the growing church should have a growing Sunday school.

(4) *Special Occasions.* Throughout the Sunday-school year occur days which should be recognized, as breaking the monotony of the regular exercises, and as attractive features of the school. Such are Christmas, Easter, Children's Day in June, Rally Day in the fall, and Decision Day, when the net is drawn for discipleship in behalf of the church. Some superintendents look upon these occasions as burdensome, but with careful preparation and an attractive program they will add to the interest of the school, while in no wise detracting from the efficiency of its educational work. An occasional social entertainment for the school, or for each department in turn, and an outing day in the summer, will strengthen that *esprit de corps* or animating spirit of the school which is its strongest drawing power in attracting new members.

(5) *Special Helps*. There are communities where certain methods may avail more than elsewhere. A well-conducted Sunday-school library, no longer needed in many places, may be of great value in villages where there is no public library. A reading room, social hall, and gymnasium may constitute the church a home for young men whose dwelling places may be in close tenement houses. Young men are in saloons, and young women are in amusement parks, who might spend their evenings under the healthy influence of the church if places were provided. These plans and other features of the institutional church will need careful and wise administration if they are to do good and not harm; but in many places they will minister to the success of the school and the church, and also to the uplifting of the community.

4. Reaching Beyond the School. Thus far in this chapter we have considered the school rather than the field. One of the chief tasks of the Sunday school, however, is to reach out and lay hold of all the inhabitants, both young and old, in the area of its influence. The following active measures have proved effective in reaching the people and winning them to the school.

(1) *Advertise*. The school should be kept before the community in every legitimate way. Merchants tell us that the secret of success is first to have salable goods, and then to advertise them; and the same principle applies to the Sunday school. Printer's ink should be used liberally, but wisely. Only neatly printed, attractive matter should be employed. Invitation cards, leaflets, programs of special services, a little periodical devoted to the school, a year book containing the school register, and many other forms of advertisement will help to inform the neighborhood that the school is at work and is ready to welcome new members.

(2) *Invite*. Every officer, teacher, scholar, and parent should consider himself a committee to speak to others about the school, and to invite his friends and acquaintances to attend it. The little children should ask their playmates, boys and girls in school their classmates, young men their shopmates, young women their associates. No printed paper can have a tenth of the power possessed by the living voice and a hearty hand-shake. It is assumed that the invitation is given only to those who are not already attached to any church or school. All possible care should be taken to

maintain a fraternal spirit, and not to build up our own wall by pulling down another.

(3) *Visit.* The field belonging to the school should be bounded definitely, and should be thoroughly and systematically canvassed. It should be divided into districts, and each district assigned to a visitor and a committee, who should know who may be included in the proper constituency of the school. For this work many schools and churches employ a paid visitor or a deaconess; and none can surpass the zeal or fidelity of many who enter upon such a vocation. But the schools which cannot afford professional workers include some teachers and some adult scholars who can give a portion of their own time to the same task. An organized class of men might be named which grew into over a hundred members through persistent work by a simple plan. A lookout committee, after careful inquiry, would report the names and addresses of men eligible for membership. Then the members in order and by appointment, in groups of two, called upon each candidate, formed his acquaintance, and invited him to the class. Sometimes thirty or forty men would call, but in time almost every man visited yielded to the friendly social influence, became a member, and soon after a worker for the class.

5. **A Danger.** A caution may be needed with reference to all these plans of recruiting the school. Advertising may be carried to the excess of becoming sensational. Invitations may be pressed upon scholars in other schools. The effort for increase may degenerate into unfriendly rivalry. A good plan may work evil when worked in a selfish spirit. And a too-rapid growth is sure to be unhealthy. The late B. F. Jacobs said, "God pity the Sunday school that gets a hundred scholars at one time!" A quiet, steady, diligent, persistent effort for the school will be of permanent benefit, rather than a spasm of enthusiasm.

XVII

THE TESTS OF A GOOD SUNDAY SCHOOL

In the United States more than a hundred thousand Sunday schools are in session every week. Some of them are very good, many are only moderately efficient, and some are poor in every respect. The question arises, what constitutes a good Sunday school? Is it possible to establish some standard of measurement by which the rank of any Sunday school can be fixed? In such a standard there must be several factors, for the points of excellence in Sunday school are not one, but many. It is the aim in this closing chapter to ascertain the criteria or the tests of a good Sunday school. The statement of these tests involves the summing up and in some measure the repetition of much already given throughout these pages.

1. **Representative Character.** The first test of a Sunday school is found in its relation to the community around it. The Sunday school is not a bed of exotic plants, dug up from their native soil, potted and protected in a conservatory. It is an outdoor garden wherein are cultivated the flowers and fruits that are indigenous to the region. A true Sunday school is a group of people drawn out of the larger world around it, and representing every element in that world, both as regards social life and age. If it represents the rich and the prosperous only, it is not a good school, unless the neighborhood is unfortunate in containing only such people. If it is a mission school for poor people in the midst of a self-supporting population, it is not a good school. If it includes few members above sixteen, and none above twenty-five years of age, it is not a good school, for it should embrace all ages from the infant to the grandfather. The school which is to stand on the roll of honor is one that fairly represents its constituency.

2. **Organization.** Another requirement for a good school is that it be well organized as a graded school. There may be Sunday schools which make up by their spirit for what they lack in system; yet the exceptions are few to the rule that in Sunday-school work organization is essential to

success. It is true that machinery creates no power; there is nothing in a constitution and by-laws to make an institution successful. It is the efforts of living men and women that bring to pass results. But organization directs and economizes power; so that, other elements being equal, the graded school quickly becomes the best school. We have already seen that a graded school is one with departments defined, with the number of classes in each department fixed according to the needs of the school, with promotions at regular periods, based either on age or examination or merit, or on all three factors in combination, with lessons graded according to the departments, and, as its most important element, with a change of teachers when the pupil is promoted from a lower to a higher grade or department. The graded system is not easy to establish; it requires firmness and tact in the authorities, and a self-denying spirit on the part of teachers; but it will abundantly and quickly repay all it costs in effort and sacrifice, and it is an essential in a really good Sunday school.

3. **Order.** A good school is orderly, yet it is not too orderly. Everybody is in place at the proper time. At the minute, and not a minute later, the superintendent opens the school. If he rings a bell, it is a gentle, musical one, held up by the leader as a signal and scarcely sounded. There is not more confusion than at the opening of any other religious service. Only one service is conducted at a time; singing is worshipful, just as well as prayer, and the Scriptures are read thoughtfully and reverently. No officers are rushing up and down the aisles during the services; no loud calls are made for order; yet there is a suitable quietness when quietness is desirable. A good school is never disorderly, yet it cannot be said that the best school is always the most orderly. Occasionally one sees a Sunday school where order has gone to the extreme of repressing all enthusiasm, where the program is too finely cut and too thoroughly dried, where the mechanism moves with the precision of the lockstep in a state prison. The ideal of the Sunday school is not that of the French minister of education who is reported to have stated that he could look at his watch and tell at that minute what question was before each class in every school in France!

4. **Spirit.** For lack of a more definite term we call the next characteristic of a good Sunday school its spirit. In any successful school one feels rather than finds a peculiar and individual atmosphere. Every member, from the superintendent to the Primary scholar, manifests an interest in the

institution; an interest of blended love, loyalty, enjoyment in it and enthusiasm for it. There is a social spirit in each class and in the school as a whole. Its members do not meet as passengers in a railway station, each one wrapped up in his own business and watching for his own train. They all have their individual friendships and social relations, yet a bond unites them all as members of one Sunday school. This peculiar *esprit de corps*, an interest in the institution, is a strongly marked feature in every progressive Sunday school.

5. Educational Efficiency. The Sunday school is in the world with a definite work—religious education. Its religion will be based on the Old Testament and kindred literature in a Jewish school; it will be based on both the Old and New Testament and supplemental literature in a Christian school; but whether Jewish or Christian, its work is the teaching of religion, as contained in the living Word, and illustrated by the lives and teachings of the heroes of the faith. The true test of a Sunday school is the answer that it can give to the question, "Does it teach the vital religious truths of the race so as to develop individual character and efficiency?" That is its task, and by its success in accomplishing it each school is to be judged; not by the splendor of its building, or the exactness of its machinery, or the enthusiasm of its members. The thirty or thirty-five minutes devoted to the lesson is the supremely important period in every true Sunday school. The time is often bound to be all too short for teaching divine truth, and printing it upon mind and memory so deeply that all the studies and pleasures of the six days between the two Sundays will not cause the teaching to fade. Yet the time is as long as the ordinary teacher (or preacher) can hold attention to one subject, and therefore in most classes it is sufficient. Toward that half hour of teaching, therefore, all the energies of the school, of the training class, home study, teachers' meeting, gradation, government, should be turned. For the vital aim of the Sunday school is the eternal message of God to men through men, so that men and women of the Christ spirit and character may be developed.

6. Character-Building. The first task, therefore, of the Sunday school is to teach the Word, but that teaching is only a means to an end, and that end is greater than mere intellectual knowledge—it is the building up of a complete character. This is more than "bringing souls to Christ," or leading them into church membership. If the sole aim of the Sunday school was to

compass the salvation of the scholar and to surround him with the walls of a church, then we might safely dismiss our scholars when they have passed through a crisis of conversion and entered the church door. But the Sunday school is to do more than save its scholars from sin. It is to train them in the completeness of a Christian character; and such a character involves not only personal righteousness but also service for God and humanity. Its aim is not to take people apart out of the world, but to set them in the world, equipped for work in making the world a Christian world, and thereby establishing on earth the kingdom of heaven. The measure by which the Sunday school accomplishes such a work as this, constitutes the final, crucial test of its success.

It cannot be said that any one of these six essentials of a good Sunday school stands supreme. They do not march in Indian file; nor are they to be set one against another in a comparison of values. These traits of a complete Sunday school should rather be regarded as one of the New Testament writers describes the traits of a complete character, in that familiar yet only half-understood passage, "As in the harmony of a choral song, blend with your faith the note of energy, and with your energy the note of knowledge, and with your knowledge the note of self-mastery,"[\[12\]](#) through all the eight aspects of the Christian; so let these six essential elements be combined to form that noble institution, the ideal Sunday school.

APPENDIX

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE AND REVIEW QUESTIONS

I. THE HISTORIC PRINCIPLES UNDERLYING THE SUNDAY-SCHOOL MOVEMENT

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Mag.**
2. **Mod.**
3. **Lay.**
4. **Unp. Wor.**
5. **Sel.-sup.**
6. **Sel.-gov.**
7. **Sel.-dev.**
8. **Bib. stu.**

REVIEW QUESTIONS

To what race in the world does the Sunday school mainly belong?

What are some of the lands in which it is found?

What does the circulation of its literature show?

What influence is the Sunday-school movement exercising upon the world?

How many salient traits of the Sunday school are named in this chapter?

What are those traits in the order named?

To what race can the ancient germ of the Sunday school be traced?

What institutions among that people contained the elemental principle of the Sunday school?

What gathering similar to a Sunday school is described in the Bible?

Who was the founder of the modern Sunday school?

In what place, and what year, was the first Sunday school held?

What aided to make this institution known?

Was the first Sunday school established under direction of the clergy or the laity?

Has the clergy, or the laity, been the more prominent in the work of the Sunday school throughout its history?

What has been the attitude of the church toward this institution?

What has been stated concerning the compensation of the teachers in the earliest Sunday school?

Was the plan of paying teachers for their services continued?

Are the majority of Sunday-school officers and teachers now paid for their services?

What has been the effect of this condition, of unpaid service, upon the growth of the Sunday-school movement?

How has this condition of voluntary, unpaid work affected the moral influence of the Sunday school?

How have the expenses of the Sunday school in most places been met in the past?

How are such expenses met in the best schools at the present time?

How has the self-support of the Sunday school in the past affected its government?

What is the present share of the church in the government of the school?

What forces have directed the development of the Sunday school as a movement?

What fact in its origin largely accounts for the unity of method in the Sunday school?

What is the text-book studied in the Sunday school?

What has been the influence of the Sunday school in behalf of the Bible?

II. THE CONSTITUTION OF THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Aim.** Rel. ins. (1) Kn. (2) Ch. (3) Ser.
2. **Meth. Tea.** (1) Teach. (2) Sch. (3) Text-b.
3. **Rel. Ch.** Bel. ch. Ca. ch. Sup. ch. Feed. ch. Sup. ch.
4. **Gov.** (1) Rights of teach. (2) Auth. of ch.
5. **Off.** (1) Sup. (2) Assoc. sup. (3) Sec. (4) Treas. (5) Fac.
6. **Mem.** All ag. all clas.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

What is a Sunday-school constitution?

What is the difference between an ideal and a practical plan?

Are all constitutions written?

What six points should be provided for in the constitution of the Sunday school?

What should be the aim of the Sunday school?

State the definition of the Sunday school as given by Dr. Vincent.

What three elements are involved in a true religious education?

What difference may be noted between the Christian ideals of the past and of the present?

What method does the Sunday school employ in its work?

What are the three essentials in the working of a school?

What does the Sunday school seek to accomplish in its pupils?

What text-book is generally used in the Sunday school?

Why is this book taught so widely?

May material outside of this book be employed in teaching?

What is the relation between the Sunday school and the church?

Why is some government needed in the Sunday school?

What two elements should be recognized in the management of the school?

Name the officers of the Sunday school.

Who should constitute the members of the school?

III. THE NECESSITY AND ESSENTIALS OF A GRADED SUNDAY SCHOOL

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Nec. Gra.** (1) Sch. as wh. (2) Cond. cla. (a) Ineq. siz. (b) Ineq. ag. (c) Lac. cl. sp. (3) Dif. adm. (a) Obt. tea. (b) Trans. sch.

2. **Ess. Gra.** Sch. (1) Dep. (2) Fix. num. cla. (3) Ann. sim. pro. (4) Ch. tea. (5) Gra. Less. (6) Bas. pro.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

Into what departments are most Sunday schools divided?

Why does not the mere division into departments constitute a graded Sunday school?

In what department is the school growing most rapidly?

From what departments does the school lose its pupils?

What is often the condition of classes for young people of fifteen years and older?

What inequalities may be noted in the classes of an average Sunday school?

What spirit is apt to be lacking in the school?

What two great difficulties are met by the superintendent of an ungraded school?

Sum up the six difficulties or defects which will be removed in a measure by grading the school.

Name the six essentials of a thoroughly graded Sunday school.

Draw a diagram representing the manner of seating the departments of a Sunday school.

What is meant by a fixed number of classes in each department of a graded school?

How should promotions be made from one department to another?

Why should not teachers accompany their classes when the pupils are promoted from one department to another?

What kind of lessons should be taught in the different departments of the school?

Should promotions be made on the basis of age, of merit, or as the result of examination?

Why cannot examinations in the Sunday school maintain the same standards as those of the public school?

IV. THE GRADING OF THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Diff.**
2. **Rem.**
3. **Meth.** (1) Grad. (2) Simul. (a) Com. (b) Ag. sch. (c) Ass. sch. (d) Ro-ca.
4. **Adv. Thor. Gra.** (1) App. (2) Ord. (3) Soc. rel. (4) Tea. wk. (5) Inc. int. (6) Obt. tea. (7) Leak.-per.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

What is the greatest difficulty to be met in grading a Sunday school?

What is the remedy for this difficulty?

What are the two methods of grading an ungraded school?

How may a school be graded by the gradual method?

What are the four steps to be taken if a school is to be graded by the simultaneous method?

What is to be done when scholars are unwilling to receive promotion?

Name seven advantages of the graded school.

Wherein does the graded school differ in appearance from one ungraded?

How is order maintained more easily in the graded school?

How does grading influence the social relations of the scholars?

Why is teaching easier in the graded school?

How does the graded Sunday school increase the interest of the pupils?

Why is it easier to supply teachers in the school after it has been graded?

What is meant by "the leakage period" in the scholars of the Sunday school?

How does the graded school hold the scholar in the school?

V. THE DEPARTMENTS OF THE GRADED SUNDAY SCHOOL

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Cradle Roll.** (1) Members. (2) Catalogue. (3) How obtained. (4) Gifts. (5) Management. (6) Value.
2. **Beginners Dep.** (1) Ages. (2) Teaching. (3) Meeting place.
3. **Primary Dep.** (1) Ages. (2) Classes. (3) Lessons.
4. **Junior Dep.** (1) Ages. (2) Classes. (3) Lessons.
5. **Intermediate Dep.** (1) Ages. (2) Classes. (3) Lessons. (4) Special aim. (5) Christian character.
6. **Senior Dep.** (1) Name. (2) Ages. (3) Classes. (4) Teachers. (5) Organization. (6) Social life.
7. **Teacher-Training Dep.** (1) Members. (2) Teacher. (3) Studies. (4) Requirements. (5) Aims. (6) Reserve class.
8. **Adult Dep.** (1) Members. (2) Classes. (3) Methods. (4) Courses of study.
9. **Home Dep.** (1) Need. (2) Plan.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

What are the four principal departments of an ordinary Sunday school?

In this chapter how many departments are described?

What are the names of these departments?

What department includes the names of the youngest children? Wherein does this department differ from most of the other departments? How should the list of its members be kept? How may names be obtained for it?

What privileges should be given to the members of this department? What are the benefits of this department to the school?

What is the name of the second department? What ages should it embrace? What should be the exercises in this department? How should these pupils be seated in the school?

What is the third department named? What ages should it include? How should it be organized? What lessons should be taught in it?

What is the fourth department? What are the ages of its pupils? How may they be classified? What lessons should be taught to them?

What is the fifth department? What ages does it include? How should the classes be formed? Why should small classes be the rule in this department? What lessons should be taught? What should be a special aim of teachers in this department? What type of Christian character should be sought?

What is the sixth department? What other names are applied to it? What ages should it include? What requirement should be made of those entering this department by promotion? How should the classes be organized? Who should teach in this department? How may the social spirit be cultivated?

What is the seventh department? Who should be included in its membership? Who should be sought as the teacher? What condition should be required of its members? What studies should be followed? How should the course be conducted? What other class should also be connected with the Teacher-training Department? How shall this class be conducted?

What is the eighth department? Who should be included in it? What are the two methods of instruction in this department? What courses of study should be taken?

What is the ninth department? Who constitute its members? What care and help should be given to these people? What should be expected of them as members of the school?

VI. THE SUPERINTENDENT

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Imp.** (N. Y. C. R. R.).
2. **Appt.** Tea. ch. past.
3. **Ter. Off.** One ye.
4. **Qual.** (1) Mor. char. (2) Dev. bel. (3) Wor. ch. mem. (4) Bib. stu. (5) Ab. exec. (6) Sym. you. (7) Tea. spi.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

What illustration from a railroad will show the importance of the superintendent?

How should the appointment of the superintendent be made? Who should unite in the selection? How long should be his term of office?

What are the traits named for an ideal superintendent?

What should be his moral character? Why is such a character necessary in his office? What story of a statesman illustrates this?

In what respects should the superintendent be a believer in the gospel?

Why should he be a member of the church? What is his duty to the Bible? How may the superintendent influence his school to follow his requests?

What should be his qualifications as an administrator or executive?

What trait in relation to the young should he possess?

What should be his mental attitude toward knowledge, especially knowledge of methods?

What story is told of a great sculptor?

VII. THE SUPERINTENDENT'S DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Gen.** (1) Sup. (2) Sel. tea. (3) Ass. sch. (4) Prog. ser. (5) Sup.
2. **We.-d. Wor.** (1) Prog. (2) Les. stu. (3) Soc. dut. (4) Seek. work. (5) Cab. meet. (6) Sp. d. (7) Conv.
3. **Dut. Sch. Sess.** (1) Pre. ear. (2) Op. pr. (3) Con. pro. (4) Dur. less. (5) Les. rev. (6) Clos.
4. **Misc. Dut.** (1) N. B. (2) Q. (3) E. L. (4) Us. B. (5) Les. per. (6) Sp. (7) Sel.-con. (8) Aim.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

Into what three classes may the duties of the superintendent be divided?

What are his general duties and prerogatives in relation to the school?

What are his duties through the week?

What social duties should he endeavor to fulfill?

How may he obtain teachers and workers?

What is the purpose of cabinet meetings?

How may the superintendent be ready for special occasions in the Sunday-school year?

What is his duty toward conventions and associations of workers?

What are the duties of the superintendent during the session of the school?

What suggestions are given concerning the conducting of the program of the school?

Who should review the lesson?

Name some miscellaneous hints concerning his work.

How may he have a quiet, orderly school?

How may he promote the use of the Bible as a text-book by teachers and scholars?

What rule should be kept with reference to the lesson period?

Under what conditions should visitors be allowed to address the school during the regular session?

What suggestion is made concerning self-control?

What aim should be kept before the superintendent and the school?

VIII. THE ASSOCIATE AND DEPARTMENT SUPERINTENDENTS

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Nec.** Gen. asst. Dept. asst.
2. **Titles.** Asso. sup. Dep. supt.
3. **App.** Nom. sup. Conf. tea. "Minor. cand."
4. **Duties.** (1) Not tea. (2) Dep. sup. (3) Prov. sub. (4) Assig. new sch. (5) Detail. sup. (6) Ch. st.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

What is the need of an assistant to the superintendent in the Sunday school?

What two classes of assistants are required in an organized school?

What titles should be given to these officers?

How should the associate superintendent be chosen?

Why should the superintendent possess the right to nominate the associate superintendent?

Should the associate superintendent be at the same time a teacher in the school?

When should the associate take charge of the school?

How should substitutes be obtained for teachers who are absent?

What class should not be called upon to furnish substitute teachers, and why?

What class will supply teachers in a properly graded school?

How, when, and where should the teachers be obtained?

When should supply teachers be ready and in their places?

What is the work of the associate superintendent with reference to new scholars?

Should new scholars select their own classes?

What part may the associate take during the general exercises of the school?

What military title might properly be given to the associate superintendent? Wherein does this title apply to him?

Give a summary of the six duties performed by the associate superintendent.

IX. THE SECRETARY OF THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Imp.**
2. **Qual.** (1) B. M. (2) R. A. (3) G. W. (4) Q. M. A. (5) Q. M. (6) C. C.
3. **App.**
4. **Assts.**
5. **Dep. Secs.**
6. **Dut.** (1) R. M. (2) R. S. (3) R. C. (4) R. S. (5) L. S. (6) C.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

Who is frequently and unwisely chosen as secretary of the Sunday school? What are the results of such a choice?

What results follow from an efficient secretary?

What six qualifications are named for the ideal secretary?

What traits of a business man should he possess?

What should be his principle with regard to regular attendance? What also should be included in his attendance?

Wherein should the secretary be a good writer?

What should be the traits of his mental action?

What exercises in the school should never be interrupted by the work of the secretary? Should he ever come to a class while the lesson is being taught?

What should be the behavior of the secretary?

How should the secretary be chosen?

How long should be his term of office?

How should the assistant secretary be appointed?

What are department secretaries, and who should be appointed to this position?

What seven duties are named for the secretary and his assistants?

What record should be kept of business meetings?

What are his duties with reference to reports from committees?

What weekly record should be kept of the attendance in the school?

What are the duties of the secretary with regard to the records of class attendance?

What general catalogue of the members of the school should be kept?
How should this record be arranged?

What is the duty of the secretary with regard to the literature used in the school?

How should the official correspondence of the school be conducted?

X. THE TREASURY AND THE TREASURER

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Early S. S.** Light expenses.
2. **Modern S. S.** Large expenses. Objects.
3. **Practical Ways and Means.** Methods. Objections.
4. **Ideal Way.** Allowance. Subscriptions. Benefits.
5. **S. S. Treasurer.** Relation to secretary.
6. **Treasurer's Work.** (1) Charge. (2) Bank account. (3) Reports and vouchers. (4) Bills. (5) Checks. (6) Audits. (7) Study of benevolent interests.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

Why was little money required by the early Sunday schools? Wherein was this fact fortunate for the schools?

Why are the expenses of the Sunday school greater than they were in the early years?

What are the principal expenses of a modern Sunday school?

What are the methods of supplying funds for the Sunday school in most places?

What is the objection to these methods?

What is the ideal method of supporting the Sunday school? Under this plan what should be expected of the members of the school? What are the advantages of this plan?

Should the same person act as secretary and as treasurer? In that case what principles should be observed?

What kind of a person should be chosen as treasurer?

What funds should be placed under his charge?

Where should he keep the money of the school? How should this bank account be conducted?

What reports should the treasurer present, and where should he present them?

How should all payments of the treasurer be authorized?

What should be done with bills against the school?

In what form is it desirable to make payments for bills?

How and when should the accounts of the treasurer be audited?

What service can the treasurer render to the school in relation to benevolent interests?

XI. VALUE OF THE SUNDAY-SCHOOL LIBRARY

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Lib. Pas.**
2. **Dec. Pres.**
3. **Cau. Dec.**
4. **Uses. G. Lib.** (1) Fam. ne. (2) Mor. inf. (3) Aid sch.
5. **Prin. Sel.** (1) Var. (2) Pop. (3) Lit. qual. (4) Mor. tea. (5) Ch. sp.
6. **Com. S. S. Lib.**
7. **Pub. Lib. & S. S.**

REVIEW QUESTIONS

Why was the library important to the school in the earlier times?

What are the facts regarding the decline of the Sunday-school library in recent times?

What causes are assigned for the decline of the Sunday-school library?

How are books more accessible now than in former times?

Why is the library no longer needed to draw pupils to the school?

How does the present educational aim of the Sunday school affect the interest in the library?

What criticism is made upon the books in most Sunday-school libraries?

How does the management of the library often interfere with the order of the school?

What three benefits are named from a well-conducted Sunday-school library?

How does the library in many places aid the school?

What four principles should guide in the selection of books?

What classes of books should be in the library?

Why must the books be popular and interesting?

What should be the literary standard for books in the Sunday-school library?

Should love stories be admitted?

What moral standards should be maintained?

What is meant by the Christian spirit in the Sunday-school library?

What kind of a library should be sought for in the educational work of the Sunday school?

How may the use of such a library be promoted in the school?

How may the public library be made useful to the Sunday schools in a city or town?

XII. THE MANAGEMENT OF THE LIBRARY

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Lib. Com.** (1) Pur. bks. (2) Freq. add.
2. **Libr.** (1) Bkm. (2) Bus. m. (3) Gen. man.
3. **Asst. Lib.**
4. **Man. Lib.** (1) Coll. (2) Ass. (3) Dist. (4) Ret. (a) Rec. sch. (b) Rec. she. (c) Fin. (d) Rew.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

Who should choose the books for the Sunday-school library?

What should be expected of the library committee?

Why should a large purchase of books at one time be avoided?

How may the committee learn of new books?

How should donations of books be regarded?

What are the advantages of small additions at frequent times?

Who should be sought for the Sunday-school librarian?

How should the assistant librarians be chosen?

What plan should be followed in collecting the books returned to the library by the scholars?

What are some plans for choosing books?

What difficulties are met in the choice of books by scholars?

How should the books be distributed?

What are the difficulties met in the return of books by scholars?

How may the loss of books be avoided?

How may lost books be traced and brought back?

XIII. THE TEACHER'S QUALIFICATIONS AND NEED OF TRAINING

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Qual.** (1) Sin. dis. (2) Lov. you. (3) Lov. ser. (4) Wil. work.

2. **Nec. Train.** (1) Gen. prin. (2) Tea. resp. (3) Dem. ag. (4) Tea. cla.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

Why does the work of the Sunday-school teacher require special qualifications?

What four qualifications are named as requisite?

What should be the relation of the teacher toward Christ?

What should be his attitude of mind and heart toward young people? Why is this attitude necessary?

What should be his relation to the Bible?

What is required of him as a worker?

When did training for Sunday-school teachers begin in America?

What have been various stages and periods in the movement for teacher-training?

What four reasons are named why the Sunday-school teacher should receive training?

How does the shortness of the time and its weekly meeting of the Sunday school relate to the training of the teacher?

How does the teacher's responsibility make his training necessary?

What does this age demand of teachers?

Why does this age make special demands upon Bible teachers?

In what condition of mind with regard to the lesson do most of our scholars come to the Sunday school?

Why does the condition of the scholar require preparation on the part of the teacher?

XIV. THE TRAINING AND TASK OF THE TEACHER

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Train. Nec.** (1) Book. (a) Or. nat. (b) Hist. (c) Geog. back. (d) Inst. (e) Eth. rel. tea. (2) Schol. (3) Schoo. (4) Work.
2. **Tea. Tas.** (1) Stu. (2) Fri. (3) Tea. (4) Dis.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

What are the four departments of teacher-training?

What in the Bible does the teacher need to know?

What does he need to know about his scholars?

What does he need to know about the school?

What does he need to know about teaching?

What are the four departments of the teacher's task?

What has he to do as a student?

What may he do as a friend?

What is required of him as a teacher?

What is his work for his class, as a disciple of Christ?

XV. THE CONSTITUENCY OF THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Rel. to Com.** (1) Const. adj. (2) Mem. rep. (3) Meth. adap.
2. **Chang. Pop.** (1) Gro. (2) Dec. (3) Ch. soc. (4) Ali.
3. **Prac. Sugg.** (1) St. fi. (2) Cul. fi. (3) Pro. f. all ele. (4) Ad. meth.

REVIEW QUESTIONS

What kind of a temple is the Sunday school?

Whence must come the members of the school?

What duty does the school owe to the population around it?

Of what should a Sunday school be representative?

What elements in a mixed community should enter into the Sunday school?

What methods should be sought in localities where the traits and needs of the people differ?

What fact regarding the population of our country brings great problems to the church and Sunday school?

Give some instances of the effect of changing population upon churches.

How often are churches generally compelled to change their constituency?

What are some causes of the changed conditions in cities and country places?

What should be done in growing communities?

What are the conditions, and the remedy for them, in a declining population?

How may a population change socially while increasing numerically?

What is the duty of a Sunday school in changing communities?

When may a church or a Sunday school rightly abandon its field?

What is the first duty of the Sunday school in relation to its field?

What is its duty to the population in its field, wherever the population can be reached?

What elements in the population should be provided for in the plans and efforts of the school?

XVI. RECRUITING THE SUNDAY SCHOOL

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Nec.**
2. **Los. fr. Sch.** (1) Sear. in sch. (2) Foll. abs.
3. **Char. Gro. Sch.** (1) Eff. (2) Attr. (3) Prom. (4) Sp. occ. (5) Sp. hel.
4. **Reach. Bey. Sch.** (1) Adv. (2) Inv. (3) Vis.
5. **Dang.**

REVIEW QUESTIONS

Why is it not only desirable but necessary to seek for increase in the membership of the Sunday school?

What is the percentage of change in Sunday schools annually?

For what should search be made in the school?

How may the absentees from the school be looked after?

What traits in a Sunday school will naturally draw to it scholars?

Why should the Sunday school be made a prominent feature in the church?

What are some special occasions in the year to which attention should be given?

What special methods of building up the school may be employed in certain localities?

How may the school be advertised?

What are some advantages in a personal invitation?

What plans for the visitation of the field are suggested?

What caution should be given concerning methods of recruiting the Sunday school?

XVII. THE TESTS OF A GOOD SUNDAY SCHOOL

BLACKBOARD OUTLINE

1. **Rep. Char.**
2. **Org.**
3. **Ord.**
4. **Sp.**
5. **Edu. Eff.**
6. **Char.-buil.**

REVIEW QUESTIONS

What is meant in the title of this chapter?

How many tests or criteria are here named?

What are these tests?

What is meant by the representative character of a Sunday school?

Why is organization necessary to constitute a good school?

What is included in a graded school?

To what extent is order a requisite?

How may the demand for order be carried to excess?

What is "spirit" in a Sunday school?

What constitutes efficiency in Sunday-school work?

For what purpose is the teaching and work of the Sunday school?

What is included in the building of a character, as an aim of the Sunday school?

How should these tests or traits be viewed?

What illustrative passage is given from the New Testament?

FOOTNOTES:

[1] An exception is to be noted in the Sunday schools of the Roman Catholic Church, where most of the teachers belong to religious orders.

[2] Bishop John H. Vincent.

[3] For qualifications and functions of the teacher see [Chapters XIII](#) and [XIV](#).

[4] For a more complete statement, see the volume of this series on The Graded Sunday School in Principle and Practice, by Dr. H. H. Meyer.

[5] Dr. A. H. McKinney, in After the Primary—What?

[6] This department is now named in Sunday schools of the Protestant Episcopal Church, and some others, the Font Roll, or Baptismal Roll.

[7] Suggested by Dr. J. H. Vincent.

[8] For full information concerning Teacher-training, courses, examinations, and diplomas, write to the State Secretary of Sunday School Work, or to the office of the International Sunday School Association, No. 140 Dearborn Street, Chicago.

[9] For plans of the Home Department, address the Secretary of the State Sunday School Association, or Dr. W. A. Duncan, Syracuse, New York, who is recognized as the founder of this system.

[10] R. L. Stevenson's Treasure Island.

[11] For detailed methods and plans, see the volume of this series on The Training of Sunday School Teachers.

[12] 2 Pet. 1. 5-7.

Transcriber's Notes:

Text uses both Sunday School and Sunday-School.

Obvious punctuation errors repaired.

The remaining corrections made are indicated by dotted lines under the corrections. Scroll the mouse over the word and the original text will appear.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK ORGANIZING
AND BUILDING UP THE SUNDAY SCHOOL ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are

located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project GutenbergTM License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, "Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation."
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.
- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project

Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to

you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the

efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment

including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a

copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility:
www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.